

THE BORDER SPY, OR THE BEAUTIFUL CAPTIVE OF THE REBEL CAMP.



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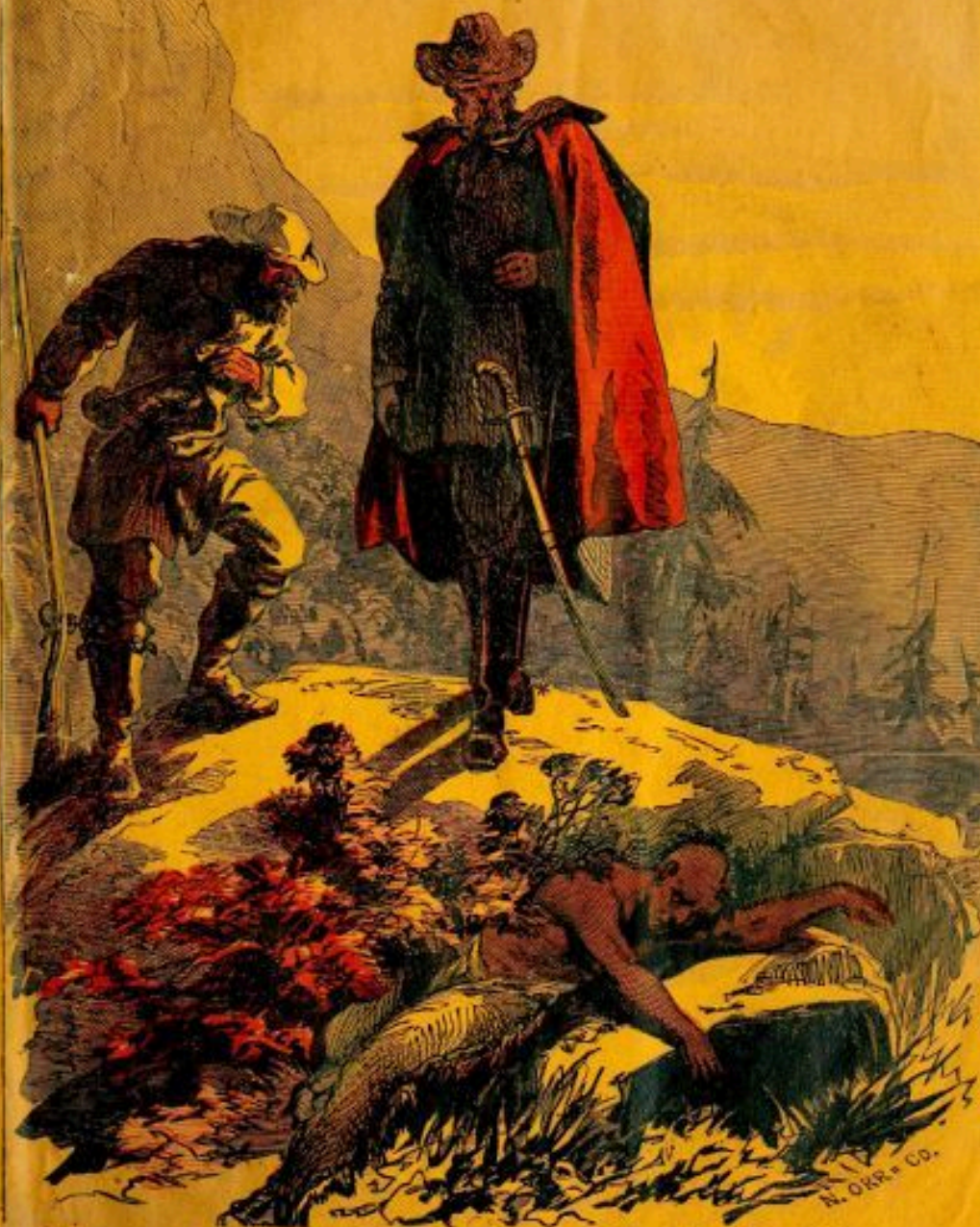
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No. 2, Complete.

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SPY; OR, THE BEAUTIFUL CAPTIVE OF THE REBEL CAMP ***

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Obvious typographic errors have been
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THE
BORDER SPY;

OR,

**THE BEAUTIFUL CAPTIVE OF THE REBEL
CAMP.**

A STORY OF THE WAR.

BY LIEUT. COL. HAZELTINE,

FORMERLY CAPT. COMPANY A, FREMONT'S BODY GUARD.

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THE BORDER SPY;

OR THE

BEAUTIFUL CAPTIVE OF THE REBEL CAMP.

CHAPTER I.

The Rebel General Price—Determination to Fight—The Sleeping Indian—Price Suspects him—He is Bound—Surprise—Escape.

Let those who fear the spray the torrent flings
Retrace their steps—I'll cross the stream, howe'er
Its brawlings may disturb me.—*Mrs. Hale.*

"By my soul, it shall be done! Yes, safety, honor, fame, fortune, all require it!"

It was a wild spot. The towering rocks reached to the height of several hundred feet above the valley below, where rolled the rapid waters of the Osage. Upon one of these jutting turrets, stood the speaker. His large form rose above the mountain oaks, standing as he was upon its most elevated point. But a close observer could not fail to notice that he was ill at ease. His eyes were restless, and as they wandered from mountain crag to the valley below, and thence to the far-reaching prairie in the distance, his frame trembled, and his fingers convulsively clutched his long iron-gray locks, as they were streaming in the morning wind.

There was nothing remarkable in his dress, except that at such a time and place he should have worn an elegant sword, which could be seen beneath a large, dark cloak, thrown carelessly over his shoulders. In other respects he was without uniform, or any mark indicating the military chieftain.

After gazing for some time upon the surrounding country, he again spoke:

"Yes, by heavens, it is a land worth fighting for, and I will—"

The speaker paused, and turning, beheld the approach of the person who had interrupted his soliloquy. A frown covered his face as he asked:

"What do you want, Johnson?"

The answer came, rough and fiercely.

"Want? revenge!"

"On whom?" asked the first speaker, as he grasped the hilt of his sword.

"Not on you, General Price; so don't fear."

"Fear!" echoed Price, "I fear no man—nothing."

"Then why do you clutch your sword as I approach?"

"Because I believe you are treacherous," replied Price.

"Treacherous! ha! ha! ha! Can I be else, and serve *you*?"

"But are you faithful to me and my cause?"

"*Your* cause!" echoed Johnson. "Why *I* thought it was your country's cause!"

"My country's cause is mine," replied Price. "Again I ask you, are you faithful to me?"

"Yes!"

"What assurance have I that you will be faithful?"

Johnson bowed his head, and did not reply.

"Answer me," said Price, sternly and suspiciously.

"General Price," replied Johnson, as he raised his head, and fixed his piercing eyes upon his questioner, "General Price, I am poor. If I were or had been a servant in heaven, and the commander-in-chief of the infernal regions had offered me a position on his staff, to escape servitude, and for promotion's sake, *not knowing him or his service*, I might have accepted. In doing so, I should have lost heaven, and in no case could have returned. Thus, as I would have no choice, I probably should serve faithfully in my new capacity, for policy's sake, even if I was deceived by the devil's promises. In much this way do I stand toward you, General Price!"

"I have not deceived you!"

"You have! You have lied to me!"

"Johnson!" yelled Price, as his sword flashed in the morning light, "no man shall address me thus, and live!"

"Hold, General Price," said Johnson, as he levelled his rifle at his breast, "you had better spare those who *must* serve you, as few are willing!"

"Curse him!" muttered Price. "But for policy's sake I must restrain myself. He shall act the spy this once—it is necessary—or I would dash him from this rock into the depths below." "Johnson," he added, speaking aloud, "you must not speak thus. It is true I have as yet been unable to fulfil my promises; but consider. We are here facing a powerful army—an army of fanatics—of devotees—who will fight to the death, while many of my soldiers are discontented, and if they fight at all, I fear will do it unsuccessfully. I have no confidence in many of my men. Why is this, Johnson?"

"I can answer, but for one."

"Then answer for yourself!"

"I will, I have no confidence in you."

"You will serve me, nevertheless?"

"Yes—I am forced to do so!"

"How forced—by whom forced?"

"Not by you, General Price, but by myself."

"Don't you see much to fight for? Look around you. Gaze upon the face of this beautiful country. Our enemies come to rob us of it. Shall we, like dogs, submit? No! by the Eternal, I will not!" cried Price, his powerful frame quivering with emotion.

"I see but little beauty here. Where is it?"

"All around—on every side!"

"I see but one bright spot, and that is—"

Johnson gazed into the valley below. His look was earnest. As he gazed, the tear-drops started to his eyes, and he bent his head upon his hands, while his breast heaved convulsively. He was deeply moved.

"Johnson, why are you weeping?" asked Price, as he regarded him with a look of surprise.

"Am I weeping?" returned Johnson, raising his head.

"Yes; some sad recollection of the past oppresses you!"

"Of the past? Yes, of the past, as well as the present, and of the future! But tell me what *you* see here, that you should love this country so much. It is not from associations?"

"No, only its beauty!"

"Its beauty? I cannot see it! Where is it?"

"Shall I describe what I see?"

"Yes, sir; I am interested to know what *you* can call beautiful."

"I will. I am standing here, upon a lofty mountain turret. Below is the Osage. Gaze upon it. Is it not majestic? Yonder it rolls, along the mountain's base, now leaping, rushing onward, like a giant army charging a deadly foe, lashing its banks as if it longed to break from its restraint, and charge the world. And there it strikes the mountain's side, and for a moment falters. It will turn aside defeated! Will it? No! It is no coward, and the mountain yields—the mountain falls—the Osage breaks the barrier, and rushes on. And now, all conscious of its victory, it pauses for awhile, or gliding gently onward murmurs its own song of glory. And listen to the strain. How it rises on the air, and is borne from crag to crag, along the lofty summits to tell that grand array of its own defeat. Look at that mountain column formed in battle line. It appears impregnable. But its ranks are broken, and its power defied. That gap is where the charge was made—that gap tells the story—its line was broken, and defeat followed. The river was victorious!"

"Good!" echoed Johnson. "What more do you see?"

"Mountains and hills where we can defy the world. And yonder is my own camp."

"Yes, your camp, containing seventy thousand true and tried soldiers. Those who have shared your victories with you. Seventy thousand soldiers! ha! ha! ha!"

"Johnson, I do not like your sarcasm. Better the enemy should over-estimate our numbers. It will intimidate them."

"Intimidate! Whom?"

"Why, not only the soldiers of the army, but their generals!"

"Asboth?"

"Yes!"

"Sturgis?"

"Yes!"

"Hunter?"

"Yes!"

"Sigel and Fremont?"

"Yes; even Sigel and Fremont can be intimidated."

"Perhaps—by an earthquake, but not by you, General Price. Asboth is a soldier, and does not know the meaning of the word fear. Sturgis—you have met him once—do you wish to meet him again? Hunter—there is lightning in his eyes; if he does not fight, it will be for want of a foe. Sigel—do you remember Wilson's Creek?"

"But of Fremont—what of him?"

"He will meet you here, if you dare remain; and his soldiers will come with him."

"Well, it may be so. Their army is now at Warsaw. They must be detained for some days yet. They are constructing a bridge at that point across the

Osage, and you will have sufficient time to visit their camps, and return before they advance. If it should be advisable to move, you can apprize us in time."

"When shall I start?"

"Now."

"Well, your instructions."

"Johnson, I confess I fear to meet that man Fremont. And yet I hate him with a bitterness which poisons all my joys. Tell him we number seventy-five thousand fighting men, well armed and disciplined. That we are strongly fortified, and for them to advance would be certain death. Tell him it is a mistake that my soldiers are discontented, but will all fight to the last. Will you tell him this?"

"I will."

"Your safety may depend upon it, for I *will* fight if I am compelled to face him with a single regiment. Last night I held a council with my officers, and we resolved to make a stand here. To retreat farther will be to bring shame upon us, and to stamp us as cowards. And I believe there is not a dozen men in my army who would not die before they would be branded as cowardly. I rely upon their pride, rather than their loyalty."

"That must be your appeal. Shall I go now?"

"Yes! Stay, Johnson; return by to-morrow night and tell me Fremont is dead, and you shall be richly rewarded. Tell me Sigel is also dead, and you shall have command of the second regiment."

"Sigel and Fremont shall die!"

"You swear it?"

"Yes, I swear they *shall* die, when—"

The remaining portion of the sentence was inaudible.

"Ugh!"

Startled, Price turned to behold, at the base of the rock upon which he was standing, an Indian, who was, apparently, fast asleep.

"Do you know that red devil?" asked Price, turning to Johnson.

"Let me see."

Johnson bent over the edge of the rock, and for some time remained silent. At last he said:

"'Tis Red-wing, as he is called by the people hereabouts; one of the Osage tribe, I believe. But you will find little good in him, although he might be made serviceable, if you could keep whiskey from him."

"Red-wing," shouted Price.

"Ugh!"

"You red devil, get up and show your colors, or I will send a bullet through your head!" exclaimed Johnson.

There was no reply. Johnson raised his rifle, but the Indian had risen, and fixing a glance of hatred upon Johnson, he said:

"Give Indian whiskey—me fight for you—me kill for you—give Indian whiskey."

Price leaped from the rock, and motioned them to follow. In a few moments he reached camp, closely followed by Johnson and the Indian.

The appearance of the rebel camp was somewhat singular.

Around the camp-fires were crowds of listless men and boys, who watched the approach of their commander with calm indifference. He passed on in silence, occasionally returning the salute of his officers, but did not pause until he reached a tent located upon a high bluff, and almost concealed from view by a thick growth of oaks. Around this tent were others, less grand in appearance, which were occupied by the leaders of his army. Stretching for some distance below, was an open field, over which were scattered rude tents, of a great variety in form and appearance. Bed blankets, worn and various in their colors, were stretched across poles, at either end of which

was placed a supporting stake, cut from the surrounding branches. All looked comfortless.

Mingled with these were seen rows of small canvas tents, giving the encampment more of a warlike aspect. The arms were also varied in their patterns. Some of them bore the appearance of the regular United States army rifle, while others were the ordinary hunting rifle or shot gun. Occasionally were to be seen soldiers in uniform, but in most instances the rough blue home-spun was worn.

As the Indian passed through the camp, his eyes wandered carelessly over the scene. When Price reached his tent, an orderly arose to receive him, and the general said:

"Send a corporal and ten men to my tent."

Then turning to Johnson, he added:

"You are known, and will require no escort beyond our lines. I shall question this Indian closely, and perhaps use him. Go!"

"Yes, general," replied Johnson, and turning he departed.

By this time a large number of officers had gathered near the tent of Price, and silently awaited the examination of the Indian, who they evidently supposed to be a spy from the Union army. Unconscious of their presence, or at least appearing to be so, the Indian stood with folded arms before the tent of the rebel general.

In a few moments Price appeared, pausing directly before the Indian. Their eyes met, and for some time they regarded each other in silence. At length Price asked:

"What is your name?"

"Me Indian—brave!"

"You are an Indian chief!"

"Me no chief!"

"Do you know me? I am chief here. Look around you—behold my warriors. They are all brave. They will conquer the enemy. If you will bring your warriors and fight with me, your hunting grounds will be safe, and your fathers' graves sacred. If these invading robbers should conquer us, you will lose your grounds; the graves of your sires will be polluted by their unholy touch, and you and your people made slaves! Will you fight with us?"

"Ugh!"

"What do you mean by that?" asked Price.

"Me ask chief."

"What is your name?"

"Red-wing."

"To what tribe do you belong?"

"Osage."

"Red-wing, don't attempt to deceive me. I can read your very thoughts!"

"Cownewunk!"

"Yes, I know you. You are a spy, and direct from the federal camp. You pretended sleep as you were lying at the foot of yonder rock, that you might hear all my conversation and report it. You have heard too much. Are there any here who have seen this fellow before?" asked Price, turning to his soldiers.

"I have seen him, and know him," replied one of the men, stepping forward. "He is called Fall-leaf, and is chief of the Delaware tribe."

The Indian sprang forward, and in an instant had broken through the crowd which encircled him, and with the speed of a deer, dashed toward the distant cliffs.

"Fire upon him!" shrieked Price.

A hundred rifles were raised, but the Indian was darting among the tents in such a manner, that no opportunity for accurate aim could be had.

"Curses on it, he will escape!" yelled Price. "Here Barclay, Rains, all of you, mount and follow. I must have that red devil, dead or alive. If he escapes, he will bear important information to Fremont."

Price sprang into his saddle and dashed forward in pursuit. He was soon followed by a score of others.

"By heavens, they have seized him!" cried Price, as he approached the outer lines of the camp, where stood the guard tent.

So it was. Just as Fall-leaf reached a narrow defile which led along the mountain's side and down to the river below, the detail ordered by Price as a pretended escort, were starting for headquarters. They met the Indian face to face, and comprehending the state of affairs, the corporal ordered,

"Seize him!"

A large knife flashed in the sunlight, which the Indian suddenly drew from concealment, and, as two of the guard sprang forward, it fell with crushing weight upon the brain of each. A third and a fourth shared the same fate.

But, at this instant one of the guard levelled a terrible blow at the head of the Indian, with the butt of his musket.

Fall-leaf, staggering back, fell to the earth. Half a dozen bayonets were instantly pointed at his heart, but, as Price approached the spot at this moment, he cried:

"Alive! alive! take him alive! I will question him first—then torture him!"

In an instant the Indian was bound and helpless.

Price, as he rode up, followed by his aids, ordered Fall-leaf to arise. The Indian was only partially stunned by the blow, and obeying the summons, he stood erect.

"Now, dog!" said Price, "you shall confess."

"Me no confess!" answered Fall-leaf.

Price stamped his foot from very rage. Turning to the guard he said:

"Throw that hell-hound upon the fire between those burning logs!"

The Indian glanced at the burning mass, and then upon the objects by which he was surrounded. The guard were about to seize him, when, turning to Price, he said:

"Me tell all!"

"You will tell me all you know of the federal army, and of your own plans?" asked Price.

"Yes! Me hate you. Me fight you. You steal pale-face—Alibamo—"

Price started, turning pale as death, as he shrieked:

"Pitch him into the fire this instant!"

The guard seized the Indian, and were about to put the order into execution, when a man bearing the appearance of a rough mountaineer, sprang forward.

"Hold on a bit, general!" were his deliberately uttered words.

Then, with the most perfect coolness, he drew his knife and severed the cords which bound the wrists of Fall-leaf.

"And who are you?" asked Price in surprise.

"Your best friend, of course, general," was the laconic reply.

"I doubt it!"

"Then you believe I lie, do you?"

"Yes!"

"Well, I will not lie then. I am your enemy. The reason I called myself your friend was, because I intended to give you good advice!"

"Indeed! And what is this good advice?"

"Why, general, that you are too far from the main body of your troops with so small an escort. You had better return!"

"What do you mean?" asked Price, alarmed.

"I'll show you," was the reply. "Here, boys; come on, quick," he shouted, turning toward the dense thicket from which he had emerged.

"We are surprised! Fall back!" shrieked Price, as he wheeled his horse.

The guard had not waited for this command, but were already rapidly retreating toward the main camp, followed by the aids of Price.

The Indian and his rescuer had already mounted a cliff which overlooked the entire ground, and turning he cried:

"Look how the cowards run! Ha! ha! ha!"

Price heard the words, and the laugh of derision. He commanded a halt, and exclaimed:

"It was but a ruse! No troops excepting our own are near us. Follow me—we can yet overtake them. There is but one path leading down the mountain, and one along the ridge. Take the lower one, Rains, with forty men. I will take the upper path, and thus we will cut them off."

The order was at once executed, and the different detachments galloped along each mountain road.

"There they are!" cried Price, as he reached the highest mountain point, about four miles from his camp. "There is a path to the right of that ledge, which leads to the valley. Quick—intercept them. They are making for that spot."

The whole party dashed forward, but were just in time to see the rescuer of Fall-leaf spring from the rock and commence his rapid descent down the rugged pathway. A volley was fired after him, but without effect.

"But where is that red-skin?" asked Price. "He is not with that fellow, and I saw him standing upon that rock but a moment since."

"He may be concealed in some of the crevices in the ledge," replied one of the party.

Search was instantly made. In a few moments one of the aids cried:

"He is here! surround the rock—he cannot escape!"

Near the summit of the cliff there was a large oak tree, which at one time had been standing erect, but from lack of soil to secure its roots, had gradually settled down until its tops were some thirty or forty feet *below* its roots. It hung over a frightful precipice of over one hundred feet. Directly below grew a large tree, whose tops reached within fifteen or twenty feet of the declined oak's branches.

The Indian finding himself thus surrounded, did not hesitate an instant. On one side was the precipice—on all other sides, the infuriated soldiery, thirsting for his blood.

Quick as thought he sprang for the oak. Down its body and branches he ran, like a squirrel skipping from twig to twig.

"Fire!" shouted Price.

"Our pieces have all been discharged at the other spy. We must load."

"Well, quick—quick, or he will escape. By heavens, look!"

The Indian had reached the extreme branches of the declining oak. He paused an instant and then sprang for the tree below.

It was a fearful leap. But he succeeded in grasping one of the topmost branches. His weight bent the frail limb, and before he could grasp another, it had broken, and his form went whirling through the air. But his form was checked by striking one of the main limbs, and with an effort he secured a firmer hold. In an instant he had reached the body of the tree, and was safe.

As he reached the base of the ledge, he turned and cried:

"Price—me meet you again!"

CHAPTER II.

*The Meeting—The tale of Wrong and Blood—The Avenger—The Oath
—The Mountain Maid—The Lover.*

Oh, I could play the woman with mine eyes, and braggart with my tongue.

But gentle heaven, cut short all intermission,
Front to front bring thou this fiend of Scotland and myself,
Within my sword's length set him; if he 'scape,
Heaven forgive him too.—*Shakespeare.*

When Fall-leaf reached the ground he started for the river, pursuing his way cautiously, but rapidly. Ever and anon he would pause and listen. It was evident he was pursued by the party from whom he had just escaped, but, as he passed along, their shouts were received only by a scornful curl of his bronze lip.

But he soon found more difficult objects with which to contend. As he emerged into an open space, he came suddenly upon the party under the command of Rains. He was not at once discovered. Bending to the earth, he crept cautiously along, concealing himself as best he could, by the under brush and tall grass. But he was not long to remain undiscovered. One of the rebel party, having espied the object of their pursuit, raised his rifle, and as its report rang through the forest, it was answered by a sharp cry of the Indian, who sprang into the air, and fell backward.

In an instant he was surrounded. Upon examination it was found that the bullet had penetrated his breast, rendering a dangerous, if not fatal wound, from which the blood was flowing profusely. He was quite conscious, but unable to move or speak.

"Shall I send a bullet through his brain?" asked one of the rebel band.

"It is unnecessary. That ugly wound in the breast will soon end him. But stay. His tribe must not know of his death. Throw him into that hole by yonder rock, then fill it up with stone and dirt."

The form of Fall-leaf was taken from the ground, and cast with violence into a cavern, or "sink-hole," about twenty feet in depth, large enough at its bottom to contain the bodies of a dozen men, but, unlike the majority of such old water-escapes to caverns in the bowels of the earth, the mouth of this hole was so small that it was quite difficult for the passage of a single form. As soon as this was done, the party proceeded to fill the entrance with rock and rubbish.

"It is done. He will trouble us no more!" said Rains.

"He is buried alive!"

"Yes, but no matter. Let us return to camp!"

The rescuer of Fall-leaf, after his escape, pushed rapidly forward to the river bank. Here he paused for a moment and listened. No sound was heard. He placed his ear to the ground.

"They are no longer in pursuit, but are returning to camp," he muttered, after a pause. Then he drew a small whistle from his pocket, and sounded a shrill note. There was no reply, and he repeated the call. Still there was no answer.

"Has he been seized by those ruffians? If so, I must return to his rescue. But, stay. I heard the report of a rifle, and then a sharp cry. He may have met some of the soldiers, and suffered at their hands. At all events, it will be useless now for me to go again to camp, as the guard will be doubly vigilant. I will return to the cabin, and if Fall-leaf does not appear by nightfall, I will then go in search of him. Perhaps Johnson will accompany me."

He plunged into the river, and soon reached the other side. Onward he went, up the mountain, not pausing for a moment, showing himself perfectly familiar with the locality. At length he emerged into an open space, near the summit of the ridge he had been traversing, at the opposite side of which appeared a rude log cabin. He sprang forward with a smile as his eyes fell

upon the dwelling, but as he came nearer the smile faded, and a look of wonder, or painful anxiety, became fixed upon his face. At length he paused and exclaimed:

"What means all this? How I tremble! What forebodings flash across my brain! If harm has come to them, I shall go mad, mad! Oh! my father—my dear sister, why are you not upon the threshold to welcome my return? No answer! All is silent there—and all is desolation, too. The creeping vines are torn away—the flowers choked with weeds—the beauty of the place departed—*she* is *not* there, else it would not be so! And I am doomed to—I must be satisfied first. Alibamo! Sister! *Alibamo!*" His voice rang out with startling clearness.

"Who calls! William! Brother!"

"Johnson—my best friend—oh! *you* are yet living!" cried William, as he sprang into the arms of Johnson, who had appeared in the cabin door.

"Yes, friend, you are living; but where is my fa—— oh! I fear to ask—I am a coward, Johnson!"

"You observe a change here, I suppose?" asked Johnson.

"Yes! But tell me *why* this change? I can bear it now!"

"First let me hear of yourself, William, and then I will answer you. Where have you been detained so long?"

"I cannot answer until you have told me of my father and my sister. Are they alive?"

"I hope so!"

"You *hope* so! Oh! Johnson, my heart will burst with this suspense. Think for a moment. I have been a prisoner now nearly three months. At the battle of Wilson's Creek I was taken by the enemy, having been left wounded upon the field. I suffered—oh! how terribly! I suffered from bodily pain—from hunger—my heart wrung by the taunts and insults heaped upon me by the wretches who held me in their power. I often felt death would be a great relief, but *hope*—the bright star of hope rose high above the dark cloud which surrounded me, and I lived on. What was that hope, Johnson? It was

of home! Father! Sister! I dreamed of liberty, even in my dungeon's depths—and on the grimmy walls I traced the flowers and vines my sister reared. The night winds whistled through my casements, and I heard my sister's voice—her song so sweet and thrilling. If dreaming thus, I woke to sadness, my father's voice would speak to me, bidding me be firm and hope. At last the news reached me, even in my cell at Springfield, that Fremont was coming. My wounds were healed, and I resolved to escape. Oh! how I longed for freedom. And why? First, that I might once more clasp my father and my sister in my arms, and then join Fremont. I watched for opportunity, and soon it came. I escaped at night, by the assistance of Fall-leaf, an Indian chief. I started at once for home. I was crossing the mountain this morning, when suddenly I came upon the outposts of Price. I saw my deliverer a prisoner, and bound. I did not hesitate, and by a stratagem, released him. The trick was discovered and we were pursued. I became separated from Fall-leaf. I should have returned in search of him, but I could not. In the distance I could see my home, never before so loved. I felt that dear ones were waiting my approach, and I hastened onward. And now, with burning brain and bursting heart I ask, are they yet living, and you reply you 'hope so!'"

"Come in, William, I will tell you all," answered Johnson.

"All! Oh! that word has a terrible sound. I cannot go in if *they* are not here! Each familiar article would only be a dart piercing my heart. Here I will listen where there is air to breathe."

He seated himself upon a log before the door, and dropping his face in his hands, he said:

"Go on!"

"William, it will require all your fortitude to listen to the narrative, for it is a tale of blood!"

"Go on!" replied William, without raising his head.

"I will. After the fall and defeat of the brave General Lyon, at Wilson's Creek, and the consequent retreat of the Union army, our position here was by no means an enviable one. It was well known that we were originally from the East. We were called 'abolitionists,' and this was enough. Other

families were equally persecuted, and we resolved to leave the country. A party of Unionists, consisting of all our immediate neighbors, assembled here to make arrangements for leaving on a stated day. We were seated around this very spot, unconscious of danger, conversing upon our present trials and future hopes. We numbered twenty souls, thirteen of whom were women and children. On a sudden a party of rebel ruffians dashed upon us from the surrounding woods. Escape was impossible, and but one of our party was armed. We sat quietly awaiting their approach, thinking this the best course to pursue, as we could not believe unarmed men would be murdered in cold blood, even by those wretches. But we were woefully in error. Their captain, one Robert Branch, rode to the side of Walter Leeman, and clove his skull. I sprang to my feet—so did our comrades. But the conflict was of short duration. Seven unarmed men could not cope long with forty mounted assassins. I saw—your father—fall—"

A groan was the only response from William. He did not raise his head.

"I seized the rifle of my fallen friend, and for a moment used it with terrible effect. I saw three villains fall under the blows I gave, but this could not last. I was stricken down, but not until I had heard the barbarous captain cry out, 'Spare that maiden beauty—she must be mine!' I could not save her—I fainted!"

"Oh! sister—Alibamo!" sobbed William.

"I must have remained unconscious for some hours, as it was dark when I awoke. I could scarcely move, either from loss of blood, or the terrible excitement and exertion I had undergone. I remained quiet until daylight, with the exception of several times calling the names of my friends. But I received no answer. And no wonder. Oh! what a sight met my eyes in the morning. I almost wished it had never come. Even the bright sun must have sickened as it gazed on such a sight."

"Was my father dead?" asked William.

"I could not find his body, although I searched for it everywhere. It is my belief that he was only wounded and then carried off, a prisoner. Five of my friends lay dead and cold by my side. Myself and your father made up the seven men who were present when the fight began. My wife was bleeding

at my feet. She was not dead—but only survived long enough to gently press my hand, and *look* her last farewell. She could not speak. I had but an indistinct recollection of her having thrown herself before me, and the blow levelled at my life was received by her. Oh! God, why was I saved to life—but not to live? For I cannot live without her! I had only been stunned by the blow."

"And my sister?" asked William.

"She, too, must have been taken captive!"

"Then, by heavens, we have much to live for!" cried William, starting to his feet.

"Much to live for? Yes—our country—our hopes—revenge! Oh! William, could you have seen that sight, *you* would feel as I now feel. Could you have felt the burning fires that seared my heart as I lifted the dying form of her I loved so truly, in my arms, and vainly begged her not to leave me yet, you would feel as I now feel. Could you have heard the cry of agony wrung from my wretched breast when I knew I no longer had a wife, you would feel as I do now. Oh! William, it is terrible—terrible!"

"What course did you pursue?" asked William.

"I consigned our loved ones to the grave, disguised myself, staining my skin with walnut bark, and then started forth for vengeance!"

"And what have you accomplished?"

"But little as yet. I have not met *the* man. I could have killed, but if discovered, or even suspected, it would prevent the carrying out of my plans. Price has employed me as a spy, and thus I have access through his lines. My plans are first, to find your father and your sister. I am almost certain she is with the rebel army, and that I heard her sweet voice, last night, singing a mournful song."

"Oh! if she lives—but let us go. I will enter the lines of the rebel army this very night. I *will* go, and if my sister is there, she shall be saved, or I will perish with her!"

"I am waiting only for to-morrow night. At that time Price will suppose I have just returned from Warsaw. Then I will go with you!" replied Johnson.

"I shall go to-night!" answered William. "But I shall enter the camp by stealth, crawl from tent to tent, listen to all conversations, and perhaps in this manner may get important information, both for our friends, and of my father and sister."

"It is a desperate hazard, William!"

"I am resolved!"

"I shall go with you!" replied Johnson.

"No, or at least, not within the camp. If you were seen before the expected time, it would create suspicion. You will conceal yourself before you reach the outer pickets. But I must find Fall-leaf. I will go to the point where I heard the rifle report. He may be wounded—perhaps dead."

Night was fast approaching as the friends took their course down the mountain, and toward the rebel camp. The fires could be distinctly seen, and the shrill notes of the fife, and the rattle of the drum, echoed across the mountain, and from hill to hill. As they reached the river, William exclaimed:

"It is nine o'clock. They are beating the tattoo in camp. In an hour all will be quiet. But let us now search for Fall-leaf. The moon is shining brightly, which will favor our search!"

The friends sprang into a small skiff which Johnson drew from its concealment in a clump of under brush, and in a moment were upon the opposite bank. Without further words, William led the way, and soon arrived on the spot where Fall-leaf had been wounded. He examined the ground carefully, and at last exclaimed:

"Here are traces of blood, and the grass is trodden down, plainly showing that a great struggle has occurred, or that a large party have passed over this place."

"Let us trace the path. Here it runs, up this slope, toward this rock. And look! here the earth has been disturbed. Do you not remember there was a

cave here? And its mouth or entrance is filled with rock and earth, which has been newly thrown there. Fall-leaf has been killed, and buried here!"

"Why buried? These rebels are not in the habit of burying those whom they murder. Why should they bury Fall-leaf?"

"Because he is of a powerful tribe, and his death, if known, would make eternal enemies of all the Delawares."

"He was their friend, was he not?"

"No! He met Fremont at Tipton. He had formerly been his friend, having often met him on the plains between this and the Rocky Mountains. His whole tribe is deeply attached to the general, and will do all in their power to assist him. And if the Delawares should learn of his death, I believe that tribe alone would almost annihilate Price and his army."

The work of removing the stone and earth which obstructed the entrance of the cave, now began.

They toiled on in silence. At length the last obstacle was removed, and William called:

"Fall-leaf! Fall-leaf!"

There was no answer.

"He is dead, or not here!" said Johnson.

"He must be here else why has this cave been filled, and so recently. I will descend and ascertain."

William sprang into the cave. He had nothing with which to strike a light, but in a moment he said:

"There are *two* bodies here. I will pass them out, and by the moonlight we can examine their features."

William lifted the bodies toward the entrance, and as he did so he said:

"One of them has been here a long time, as the decomposition indicates. Lay them on the ground, Johnson, and I will search farther!"

After a moment's pause, Johnson asked:

"Do you find anything else?"

"No—nothing!"

"Then come out."

William left the cave, and as he did so, Johnson grasped him by the arm, and asked:

"Will you be calm!"

"Yes—yes!" replied William. "But what do you mean?"

"Will you think *only* of revenge?"

"Of revenge! What do you mean?"

"Look there!" cried Johnson, pointing to one of the bodies which had been taken from the cave.

"My father!" shrieked William, as he glanced at the corpse.

"Yes, your father! But, pray be firm—be calm."

"I am calm—very calm!" sobbed William, as he sank beside the inanimate clay.

"The Indian is recovering, William," said Johnson.

This was indeed the case. In spite of his long confinement in the cave, and the suffering endured from his wound, Fall-leaf had recovered sufficiently to speak. He had partially raised himself from the ground, and was resting his head upon his elbow.

But William was too deeply affected to observe this, or to notice the words spoken by Johnson.

At last he arose from his prostrate position beside his father's corpse, and for a moment gazed wildly around him. He pressed his hands to his temples, as if endeavoring to collect his scattered thoughts. His eyes fell upon the Indian, and then were raised to Johnson.

"I remember all now!" he said. "I hoped it was a dream—but it is a dread reality—but not all—not all!"

"William! You know me?"

Johnson gazed upon him with earnestness.

"You think I am mad, Johnson! But I am not. Hark! Great heavens! Listen!"

Johnson shook his head.

"Here, Johnson—here! kneel with me—here, beside my father's clay! *That* voice tells me I have work to do!"

"What voice, William?"

"A thousand voices calling for vengeance. But, kneel with me now, and swear by the God of truth and justice—swear by my wrongs, your wrongs, our country's wrongs—swear by your murdered wife, to join me in pursuing these fiends in human form, until they are swept from the earth!"

"I swear!" cried Johnson, as he knelt beside his friend.

"Me—me next!" answered Fall-leaf. He made an effort to get upon his feet, but fell back.

"That voice again?" cried William, starting up, and listening.

"I hear nothing!" answered Johnson.

"But I do! It is a sound soft and plaintive. It echoes along the mountain, and I know its melody. It is the voice of Alibamo."

For a moment all were silent and listened eagerly to catch the distant sound, but it was so low and indistinct that nothing definite could be made of it.

"It is only the murmur of the river, William," said Johnson.

"To me it is the murmur of an angel, and I will trace its source. Johnson, you must remove Fall-leaf to our cabin. His wound is painful, and needs attention. Bury my father first, and then perform this duty. I will meet you to-morrow night."

Without further words, William darted from the spot, and commenced his course up the mountain toward the camp of Price. Now and then he paused to listen, but all was silent, save the murmur of the breeze among the oaks, and the rippling of the rills.

"Am I dreaming?" he at last exclaimed. "No—no! there is her voice again! Sister!"

William paused, listening intently.

Upon the clear, moonlight air, rang out a voice, sweeter than angels' echoes. But the words; they spoke of love—of willing captivity—of future joys mingled with hope. Of her brother—her father—*and her lover*—"HARRY!"

"Is it possible *she* has loved a rebel! O God! is my cup of bitterness not yet full? But I will steal closer, and listen!"

In a short time he reached a rock, upon which, in the clear moonlight, could be seen, two forms. The one a female, pure and lovely as the moon's own rays; the other, a delicate youth, of about twenty years of age, yet bearing the impress of a noble soldier. Alibamo spoke:

"Are you not required in camp, dear Harry?"

"Yes, love—but here, also!"

"You would not sacrifice your duty for love?"

"My first duty is here—with one I love so wildly. And you love me, do you not, Alibamo?"

"Oh! Harry—I cannot tell you how dearly!"

"Then you are not *my* sister!" shrieked William, who had heard these words.

"Halt! Who comes there?"

These words were spoken by one of the sentinels of the picket. In an instant, William had darted from the spot. The sentinel fired upon him without effect. He was soon out of danger, and then paused irresolute. At length he said:

"It will be useless to return to night. That gun has aroused the camp, and they are beating the long roll. But, why should I wish to return. My sister loves a rebel. No! what is that? Why, he—her lover is waving the Stars and Stripes from yonder rock. He knows I see him—and hark!—she—my sister—is singing—The Star-Spangled Banner. Surely this is all a dream."

CHAPTER III.

The General—His Quarters—The Delay—The Expedition—The Instructions—The Departure.

We should have else desired your good advice
(Which still hath been both grave and prosperous)
In this day's council; but we'll take to-morrow,
Is't far you ride?—*Shakespeare.*

The Union army, or rather a portion of it, was encamped at Warsaw, waiting for the completion of the Osage river bridge, which was being built by the soldiers, at that point. The division under the command of acting Major-General Sigel, had succeeded, after an extraordinary effort, in reaching the west side of the river, but it was impossible to convey the heavy trains which accompanied the army across, without something more than the small scow, which was termed a ferry-boat, and plying between Warsaw and the opposite shore.

The divisions under the command of McKinstry, Hunter, and Pope, had not yet arrived. Therefore the troops occupying Warsaw and its vicinity, numbered only about ten or twelve thousand. Under the incessant toil of the soldiers, who labored day and night, it was expected that the bridge would be complete by the time the rear divisions of the army arrived.

As a matter of prudence, it was deemed necessary to keep the rebel hosts in ignorance with regard to the situation of our forces. It was not expected that they would advance upon us, although many expressed a desire that it should be so, believing that Price would never meet our entire army, and that farther pursuit of that general was altogether fruitless. This opinion, however, was not general, and the more experienced officers were of the opinion that a few days would bring a great and decisive battle, but had perfect confidence in our complete success. They felt, that if the rebel

leader possessed one particle of *pride*, he *must* make a stand, after the oft-repeated oaths that he had taken, to meet and overwhelm the federal troops.

Spies were reporting each day, that Price had sworn to meet, and give us battle; but the opinion among this class seemed to be, that he would fall back to the Arkansas line, and make a junction with Texan troops, said to be on the march toward Missouri. Many reports were circulated with regard to the strength of the rebel army, some saying it numbered over seventy thousand, while others declared there were not over thirty thousand armed men connected with it.

But the general commanding the Union forces, placing little reliance upon the statement of those spies, whom he believed could be bought upon either side by the highest bidder, determined to send known and trusty men into the very camp of Price. The delay of the army would afford sufficient time for doing so. It soon became known throughout camp that the general wished the services of some two or three daring spirits, for a dangerous enterprise, although *what* the nature of this enterprise might be, was not known, or whether the officers required were to take soldiers with them or go alone.

The headquarters of our army were situated on the hill at the upper and east side of Warsaw. The tent of General Fremont, which was of the Sibley pattern, modest and unassuming in its appearance, stood in the edge of an oak grove, near the house of the rebel judge Brown. In no way was it distinguishable from others which surrounded it, except that before the door, there was a single soldier of the body-guard, with drawn sword, acting as sentinel. Adjoining the general's tent were others of the same pattern, which were occupied by his staff. On the slope above, and almost concealed from view among the trees, was the encampment of the sharpshooters and the Benton cadets.

The reader will follow me along the main road, and passing headquarters some twenty rods, will see, on a parallel with the street, a line of tents, which were the staff officers' of the cadets. Just before reaching these we will turn a little to the left, and proceed for a short distance down a narrow lane. At the extreme right of the cadets' camp, stands a tent, of precisely the

same appearance as those surrounding it, the entire regiment occupying the kind known as the Fremont tent. Let us enter.

It is occupied at this time by four men, who, by their uniforms, are at once recognized as officers. Two of these officers display the rank of captain, by their shoulder-straps, the other two that of first lieutenant. The dark blue and bullion of one of these lieutenants indicate a staff officer. He is the regimental adjutant.

"William Nettleton!" called one of the officers.

"Here, captain," was the ready response.

"Bring more coffee!"

"Yes, captain."

And away started the person addressed as Nettleton.

It will be necessary to give a brief description of this personage, as he is to play a conspicuous part in the following events. He was in height, about six feet. His neck was very long, his hair nearly white—not from age, but naturally so; his brows and eyelashes of the same color, his eyes were of a light green, his mouth large and gaping, his teeth extending like a battering ram, his form very lank and lean, his legs immensely long and thin, and very knock-kneed, and his feet—oh! ye gods,—such feet. They were about the shape of his own knapsack, and almost as large, and his legs seemed to join the feet exactly in the middle, extending as far to the rear as front. And when he walked, one would almost fancy that at every step he would fall to pieces. In fact, he looked unlike man or animal, and at first sight he might have been taken for a deformed idiot. But whoever supposed him as such, on a very short acquaintance would discover their mistake. He had been detached from his company as the captain's servant, was very much attached to him, and delighted in being called the "captain's body guard."

In a moment his voice was heard exclaiming:

"Here, ye darn lazy skunks, you; what for did you let this fire go out? Captain wants some more coffee, and now it's all cold, darn ye."

A burst of laughter followed this, as the adjutant remarked:

"Captain, you have a jewel in that fellow."

"Yes, but a rough one."

"A decided character, I wish you would transfer him to me."

"Not for his weight in gold. I have adopted him," replied the captain.

"I will wager my commission, he will fight!"

"I intend to try him!"

"In what way?"

"I will tell you presently. But, let us talk of other matters now. You heard what the colonel said?"

"Ye darn lazy skunks you!"

"William's voice again!" replied the adjutant, laughing, which was joined in by the four officers present.

"Perhaps William's address to his squad *might* apply to us, for we have done very little lately. But, the colonel tells me that Fremont wants some one to —"

"Go to the devil!" again shouted William. He was, of course, addressing himself to the cook and boys who surrounded him, and who were always teasing the fellow, and of course took all he said or did in good part.

"William is apt in answers, if replying to us, captain. At all events, *that* reply was more apropos than the first," said the adjutant.

"To go on some important service. I expect," continued the captain, "it is to visit the camp of Price as a spy. There has nothing been said about the men going with us, or with the officer who may volunteer to go, and of course the general would not expect an officer of the cadets to take men from other regiments, and ours are all engaged in building the bridge."

"Have you received any definite order?"

"Yes, and I at once sent for you all. The order includes our names, and we are to report to the general at four o'clock. It is now two."

"Anything to relieve this present monotony. I for one am tired of it. I came to Missouri to fight, and not to run. True, we are running *after* Price, but that does not satisfy me. I confess that I am ambitious, and I want to do something that will bring my name prominently before the world; and I want—"

"Coffee, sir," said William, entering the tent.

"Go on, adjutant William, place the coffee upon the table. You were saying that you want—"

"Whiskey, sir," again repeated William, as he handed a bottle toward his captain, which he had taken from the mess-chest.

"William, be quiet; don't speak again," said the captain.

"I won't, captain, but I heard the adjutant say he wanted something, and I thought of course it was the black bottle."

"Silence, Nettleton."

"I will, captain. Shall I make it hot?"

"Nettleton, will you shut your mouth?"

"I can't, captain, my teeth are too long."

"Go after some wood for my fire, William. Take your squad with you."

"Yes, captain."

In a moment Nettleton was heard calling:

"Here, ye darn lazy skunks you, captain wants some wood. Come, be quick, or I will have you all in the guard-house."

"Now, adjutant, what were you going to say?"

"Merely, that I want my parents, my relatives, to feel that I have done something that they may be proud of me!"

"Adjutant, that is a natural impulse of the human heart. But this is not your only motive?" The captain fixed a piercing look upon him. He bent his head for a moment and was silent. At that instant the band struck up the Star-Spangled Banner.

"No!" cried the adjutant, springing to his feet. "That is *not* my only motive. I thought *you* knew me better. It is true I love my father and my mother, my brothers and sisters, and it would gratify my pride if I could return home after this war is over, an acknowledged hero; but, I love my country, and while I enjoy the self-satisfaction derived from great deeds, I desire my country should derive all the benefits. It may be passion with me—this love of country—but I trust it is principle. My fathers fought, and I should hate myself if I had so far degenerated as to fight from selfish motives, or *fear* to fight. From youth I have dreamed of battle-fields, and glory for myself, never thinking it would be in this, our own America, that my first battle would be fought. But it is so, and my manhood views differ somewhat from those of childhood. Now I long for the battle-field, and my country's glory!"

"I have no doubt of your loyalty, Harry," replied the captain. "Neither do I doubt your love for your friends and your country. But you have just returned from the camp of Price, and, if I mistake not, you love that camp."

Harry did not reply. The two other officers gazed upon the adjutant with a look of surprise, and then turning to the captain, one of them said:

"Love for the camp of Price!"

"Oh don't be alarmed, gentlemen. You know the good book tells us that where the treasure is, there the heart will be."

"These are strange words; however, explain."

"Why, can you not guess?"

"Relatives there!"

"No! that is, not at present. How soon a relative *may* be there is quite another thing."

"Come—come, captain, explain."

"Why, look at Harry's face; you can find the explanation there. What but love, and love for the *softer* sex, ever made a man like Harry grow pale and melancholy. You have not heard him sing 'Noble Republic' recently, have you? You know the free bird never sings when its mate has been caught and caged."

"*Caught* and *caged*! Why then if Harry really does love, it is not a rebel beauty?"

"I will answer that," cried Harry. "No, she is not a rebel beauty, but is, and ever has been a true Union girl. I call her girl, for she is so innocent, so artless, so beautiful, and yet she possesses firmness and resolution I never could have expected in one so young. I met her years ago in New York. She was then a little child, but I loved her even then. When I visited the camp of the rebels last week, what was my surprise to meet her. I learned her history, and I found she was detained as a prisoner. But it is growing late. In ten minutes we must meet the general. I will explain all this at some future time."

"Ah! here comes Nettleton. I want him," said the captain.

Nettleton entered the tent.

"William, tell me which you prefer: to serve in the ranks, or to act as my body-guard?"

"Why, captain, I want to remain just as I am. Why? You don't want to have me superceded, do you?"

"Oh! no; but why do you object to being in the ranks?"

"I can't turn round quick enough!"

"Why?"

"My feet are too big?"

"I am afraid, William, that you are a coward!"

"I don't think I am, captain!"

"If you were to meet the enemy in battle, would you run?"

"Which way?"

"Why, *from* the enemy."

"I suspect I should, captain!"

"Why, William, you said you were not a coward!"

"Well, I say so again!"

"Then why would you run *from* the enemy?"

"Why, *I must follow my captain of course!*"

"Good, Nettleton, good," shouted the listeners. "You are matched this time, captain." And all joined in the laugh.

"Well, William, I expect I shall go to-night, where there is some danger. Will you go with me?"

"Yes, captain."

"Think again, William. We may both be killed?"

"Oh! well, if we are only *both* killed, I can serve you still?"

"Serve me! In what way?"

"By bringing *coal for your fire*, instead of wood!"

"Come—come, William, no more of this levity. If you will go, or wish to go, you can do so. Saddle White Surry for yourself. Give my brown horse to Swasey's nigger! prepare my horse, and be ready in half an hour. Come, gentlemen, it is time to report to the general."

The four officers left the tent, and proceeded to the headquarters of the commanding officer. They were duly announced by the guard.

They entered the tent. The general was seated at a small table, busy with his papers. But he rose instantly, and in a cordial manner, invited them to a seat.

"We report for orders, general," said the captain.

"Then you have resolved to undertake this task?" answered the general in an inquiring manner.

"Yes, although ignorant of its nature, we have resolved to attempt anything that may benefit our army and our cause. You have only to give your commands, to have them faithfully executed, if it is possible to do so!"

"I have no commands to give. That which I ask is a mere request, which you are at liberty to decline if you wish. Here are the directions. You, Captain Hayward, will act as you think best, so far as details are concerned, and will take command. If, however, after reading the directions contained in that envelope, you wish to decline the service, let me hear of it soon as convenient."

"You have our answer now. Good evening, general."

"Good evening, gentlemen."

The officers at once left the tent, and proceeded to that of the captain.

"Be seated," said Captain Hayward, as he opened the envelope. He glanced over its contents, and turning to his companions he said:

"We must disguise ourselves. It is as I suspected—we are to go to the camp of Price. I have in my possession one of the secesh uniforms, which formerly belonged to an officer. I shall wear it. You will dress in the plain homespun worn by the rebel soldiers."

"Where are we to procure them?"

"They will be sent to my tent in a few moments. The general has provided them. William Nettleton!"

"Yes, captain."

"Are our horses ready?"

"Yes, captain."

"Tell my cook to prepare rations for three days for six men. Take care that they are properly placed in our haversacks—then bring the horses around to my tent-door. Stay, here is a suit of clothing I wish you to put on, and

wherever we go, understand you belong in Springfield, and have just left the hospital there. After we pass our lines, you know you are a rebel, so lay aside that rifle, and take the shot gun I gave you. 'Swasey's nigger' will not be armed at all. Go."

In a few moments the officers had changed their uniforms for the rougher dress. Their horses were brought up, and they at once took their leave of camp, followed by the negro and William Nettleton.

CHAPTER IV.

The Journey—The Cowardly Negro—Nettleton's Method—Meeting the Rebels—He will fight—Powder discovered—The Arrival.

The devil damn thee black, thou cream-faced loon!
Where got'st thou that goose look?—*Shakespeare.*

The party rode rapidly to the river, and were soon upon the opposite shore. Turning to the east, they passed along a narrow road which wound its course along the river's bank. For fifteen or twenty miles the horsemen did not pause, and not a word was spoken. At last Captain Hayward ordered a halt, and the party dismounted. The horses were secured to the surrounding trees, and Nettleton and the negro left to guard them.

"Come with me, comrades," said Hayward, as he took his course toward the river's bank.

In a moment they were seated by the side of the rapid Osage, entirely concealed by the thick growth of underbrush by which they were surrounded.

"It is better that our servants should not hear our conversation," remarked Hayward. "And now, gentlemen, we must lay our plans. I wish every one to speak freely. You know our object, of course."

"I know its nature; but perhaps you can give us details we are not acquainted with," answered Lieut. Elsler.

"They are merely the instructions previously given, with a trifling difference. We are to reach the camp of Price by noon to-morrow, or to-day, as I see it is after twelve o'clock," replied Hayward. "When we arrive within a mile of the outer pickets, we must conceal our horses, and leave the darkey to watch them. I shall walk boldly into the camp, and report myself to Price as an officer and messenger just arrived from McIntosh's command."

Our colonel was in the same regiment with him, the 10th regulars, before this war broke out, and has given me an exact description of his person and peculiarities. To throw Price off his guard, and to prevent his questioning me too closely, I shall repeat some of the peculiar expressions of Mac, which, of course, Price will at once recognise, and that, together with my secesh uniform, will settle matters. I am to tell some story which will induce him to make a stand here, or to advance upon us at Warsaw; or, at least, to give us battle at Springfield. I shall tell Price that it is the advice of McIntosh to meet Fremont on the Osage, if possible, and say that the reason of this advice is, that Mac is in communication with one Marshall, an officer high in rank in the federal army, and that Marshall tells him the exact position of our forces. Of course our numbers are to be greatly underrated. The federals, I shall say, profess to have thirty-five thousand men, *all* anxious to fight, when in reality they have not more than twenty thousand, poorly armed, and mostly arrant cowards, who will run at the first discharge of the confederate guns. I shall tell Price that Mac has perfect confidence in the information received through his friend, and sent me forward at once to communicate with him. You must all remain concealed until I come to you. I shall remain in his camp until evening, get such information as I can with regard to his actual strength, and what he intends doing, and when the countersign for the night is given out, I shall manage to procure it, and then return to you. Our further plans we can then arrange."

"But, if there should already be some of the officers from McIntosh's department, present, and should declare you did not belong there!"

"It is not at all probable. Mac has not received any information at all."

"But you know Price has sent spies into our camp, and if any of them should be present and recognise you?"

"I must take the chances. If I do not return to you by eleven o'clock, you will know that I have been arrested."

"If ye are arrested we will go in and lick the nasty chaw-tobacker skunks, and get you out," said Nettleton, who had approached just in time to hear the last sentence.

"William, I told you to remain with the horses, did I not?"

"I know you did, captain, but you see I had to come and report myself under arrest."

"What have you been doing, William?"

"I've killed the nigger!"

"Not Swasey's nigger?"

"Yes, I have!"

"Why did you do that?"

"Why, captain, ye see the black sneak got skeered and turned almost white, and shivered like a poodle when he's going to ketch a licking. And sez I to him, you dog or rascal, what are you skeered about? And when he tried to speak his teeth rattled so that I thought it was a wagon coming over the mountain. Then he jumped on one of the horses and sez 'I'm g'wan back!' So I just tapped him on the head with the but of my gun, and I'll be blasted if the critter didn't get right off the horse and lay down without my telling him to do it. But, I didn't want to kill the black skin; I didn't think his pate was so soft. Niggers generally ain't."

"What was the fellow frightened about?"

"I don't know, captain, except it was the dark!"

The officers exchanged glances, and Hayward said in an under tone:

"It was just as I should have expected Nettleton to act!" Then turning to William he said:

"Go back to the horses, and don't kill any one else to-night!"

"I won't, captain, unless they are enemies or cowards," replied William, as he turned to depart.

"I would trust that fellow with my life," said Hayward, gazing after Nettleton.

"But you were saying, captain, if you did not return by eleven o'clock, we should know you were arrested. What shall we do in that case?"

"You can do nothing. Return to camp and leave me to my fate. However, I apprehend no such danger. But, Harry, you spoke of a beauty whom you love, and who is a prisoner. Have you anything to request? Perhaps we can serve you in this matter."

"Yes, Harry, we will try," replied Elsler; "but will you not give us the remaining portion of your adventure?"

"Have I time?" asked the adjutant, turning to the captain.

"Oh! yes, *true* love affairs are usually short but sweet. I presume it will not take you very long to speak of bright eyes, ruby lips, flowing tresses, and soft whispers—sighs, and all that kind of nonsense. Go on."

"Captain, I know *you* think lightly of love, but wait until you have seen Alibamo. You will love her, too. She is a being to love—beautiful as morning—gentle as a summer evening's breeze."

"Exactly, and so on indefinitely. Young ladies are always all this, and more, in young lovers' estimation. But give us *facts*, Harry. She is a prisoner, and that interests me. Perhaps I can see her to-day, and give her some message from you, which will give her hopes of liberty."

"I have very little to say, but much to do. While I was with the scouting party some days since, I went to the camp of the rebels. I did not seek admittance within their lines, but from a commanding point I saw their whole army, although I could not form any correct estimate of their strength. As I was returning I met Alibamo, in company with a squad of soldiers who are acting as her guard. She recognized me at once, and was about to spring forward, when I raised my finger to my lips, in token of silence. She understood me. She knew I was not a rebel but the soldiers supposing me, from my rough, homespun clothing, to be one of their own friends, did not notice me, or observe the sign of recognition and silence which passed between myself and the lady. I spoke to the soldiers: 'Hold on a moment,' I said, 'if I am not greatly mistaken, I have met this beauty before in New Orleans.' As I spoke these words, I fixed my eyes upon her. I tried to look hatred. She understood me, and replied that she had met me before. 'And I loved you,' I said, 'but that love was of no avail. You left me. I determined to follow you, for revenge, but I did not know where you

were. And now I meet you near my own camp. And you are a prisoner! Am I not revenged?"

"The soldiers heard every word I had spoken, and understood me just as I spoke. She then replied to me thus:

"It is true we have met before, and you told me of your love. I turned from you, I scarcely knew why, but you were mistaken if you thought I did not love you. That I left the place where we first met was unavoidable. And because I left thus, you wish to revenge me! Well, you have your revenge. My father and my brother, most likely, have been murdered by rebels such as you. I am in the hands of a ruffian. I cannot escape—I meet you, and you taunt me! Well, you *are* revenged!"

"Thus she briefly told me her story. I asked her if she could love me yet, and she replied she could. I pointed to a certain rock, and told her that, as soon as my duties would permit, I would meet her there. Of course I could not permit her to escape, and unless she would promise to remain, and become one of us, I could do nothing for her. One of the guard said she could not meet me there alone, as Branch would not allow it, but she might be permitted to *walk* if she chose to do so, in the evening, accompanied by the present guard. I thanked them, said I would let Alibamo know when I could come, and if they would keep the matter a secret, I would pay them well for it. I could afford to do that, as my father was rich. Believing me a rebel, they readily consented.

"Of course, you know my plans now, captain. Arrange all your affairs, and then communicate with Alibamo for me. Tell her to meet me at eleven o'clock at the place appointed. There will be a guard of twelve, captain. What say you?"

"We will rescue her!"

"Can we do it?"

"Nettleton *alone* could do it! Why do you ask, can *we*?"

"It is an individual hazard!"

"Your cause is ours, Harry. But come, it is time to continue our journey. It will be daylight before we reach our destination."

As they approached the spot where the horses were tied, they saw the negro standing erect, and Nettleton giving him advice which was as follows:

"Now look a here, 'Swasey's nigger,' you are a mean feller any how, and ain't much account no way. But, don't go and make a sneak of yourself by being such a milksop of a coward. Cos why? You see, I hit you on the head, and I thought you was killed. I didn't care much, no way, kase you're such a mean soldier, any way. But just behave yourself, and don't be a sneak any more, and I'll let ye live; but if you show the white feather, as captain calls it, you will find out that the captain's body-guard don't have any turn-tails about *him*; no, sir, Mr. Darkey!"

"I won't be coward no more, Massa Nettleton. Golly, don't I wish dis chile was brabe like you. But, ye see, Massa Nettleton, when dis chile gets in de woods, and de rebels are aroun', it makes his har stan' on end."

"Well, don't you do it no more, or I make *you* stand on end!"

"William Nettleton," called the captain.

"Yes, sir! want the horses?"

"Yes, William."

As the party mounted, and prepared to depart, Captain Hayward said:

"Why, William, you informed me that you had killed that gentleman of color. I see he is alive, and apparently unhurt."

"Why ye see, captain, his skull is so thick, it ain't so easily cracked. But, if you'll only just examine his skull, you'll find a lump there big enough for a breastwork."

"Do you think it has improved his condition?"

"I guess it knocked some of the fear out of his woolly top-piece, and if I have occasion to hit him again, I bet it will knock it all out."

"George, what are you afraid of?" asked Hayward, speaking to the negro.

"I'se most afeerd of Cap'n Nettleton, massa," replied the negro, as he opened his mouth and grinned.

"Did he hurt you very much?"

"Considerable much, massa cap'n. Golly, I thought the gun crack de skull, sure."

"But you are not afraid of the rebels, are you, George?"

"Not when I'se good way off!"

"Captain," said the adjutant, "we shall have trouble with this fellow. Had we not better send him back?"

"Perhaps it would be the best course."

"Oh! massa cap'n, don't send dis chile back alone. De rebels catch him, sure. And den, O Lord golly, dey whip me to strings, *sure!*"

"So they would. The best thing you can do is to keep quiet. We shall conceal our horses when we arrive within a few miles of the camp, and you must remain with them. If you do so, you will be safe, but if you attempt to return alone, you will be caught and whipped to death."

"Oh! golly! massa, dis chile will do just what massa cap'n tell him. But is ye gwan to lebe dis chile all stark, staring, breving alone?"

"All alone, George, and your only safety will be in keeping perfectly quiet so that you will not be discovered."

"Can't Massa Nettleton stay?"

"William," said Hayward, "give that fellow a lecture."

"Yes, captain. Look a here, you disgrace of your country," said Nettleton, as he rode up to the side of the negro, "look a here; if I hear you open your mouth again, I'll cram the muzzle of my gun down your throat, and then shoot it off. Lord wouldn't there be a splutterin of nigger!"

"I'se dumb, Cap'n Nettleton."

"Well, talk no more. Come, comrades, double quick."

Captain Hayward struck his horse and dashed forward, followed by the entire party.

It was about two o'clock in the morning, as they were riding rapidly along, when Nettleton rode up to the side of Captain Hayward and said:

"Captain, don't you see them sneaks ahead?"

The captain looked toward the spot indicated and replied:

"*Stumps*, you mean, William."

"No, golly massa, dem's no stumps; dem's hooman beins. Dar, don't you hear dat horse whinner?"

"Halt!" said Hayward. "Look to your pistols—have your swords ready—there are about twenty of them. They see us, and are awaiting our approach. It is too late to conceal ourselves. Forward!"

The party moved onward at a slackened pace. When they had arrived within forty yards of the horsemen, Captain Hayward said:

"Halt here a moment. I will ride forward."

In an instant he had reached them. He rode up carelessly and fearlessly.

"Halt!" cried the leader, addressing Hayward.

"To what purpose, sir?" demanded Hayward.

"For examination!" was the response.

"The moon is shining brightly. You can easily examine my face and uniform. But perhaps you prefer to examine these?" said Hayward, drawing his revolver with one hand and his sword with the other.

"Precisely!" was the reply, "*unless you pass examination first.*"

"Well, sir, as I don't intend to submit myself to any such process, we will commence with these at once. Forward, boys!" shouted Hayward, turning to his own party, "*here are a set of d——d home guards!*"

Hayward was well satisfied that the party was no other than a portion of Price's army, and his rough allusion to the "home guards" was intended to impress them with the fact that he and his party were also of the rebel army. The ruse succeeded. As the remainder of Hayward's party were approaching, with drawn swords, the officer in command of the other squad, said:

"Don't trouble them. I think we are all cut from the same piece of cloth."

"Then you are *not* what I suppose?" asked Hayward.

"We are of the confederate army, and have just come from camp."

"Indeed! then you need not fear us!" said Hayward, laughing. "That is, if you will give a good account of yourselves. Halt, boys, don't annihilate them."

The leader of the twenty joined in the laugh, as he saw the remaining five approach.

"Oh! Lord! massa," said the negro as he approached, "don't—don't—if dem's home guards we will be—"

Somehow in turning, just at that instant the gun which Nettleton carried, came in violent contact with the darkey's nose, which checked his further utterance.

"Yes, ye dam skunk, you maybe mighty glad them ain't home guards. If they was, you'd catch Jerusalem, I tell ye what, ye black rascal!"

The darkey did not appear to comprehend, but dared not speak.

"Whither bound, boys?" asked Hayward.

"Well," replied the leader, "we are going to scout around the federal camp a little, to find out what we can. I suppose we can get in, as we shall go separately, and if surprised, we shall pass as home guards. I fancy no difficulty, as you mistook us for such."

"Still, you must be very careful. These Yankees are very sharp, I am informed," replied Hayward.

"Well, if we are attacked we must do our best, of course. But we may not go as far as Warsaw. Our principal object is, to get some kegs of powder, which are buried on the Osage, just above—let me see."

The officer took a card from his pocket and read aloud:

"Just above Rapid creek, on the west bank, near a large oak tree, which is marked C. S. A."

"Powder! good! We are in need of it," answered Hayward. "By the by, I am out of powder—so are our entire party. Have you any to spare?"

"Oh! yes, here is a flask."

Hayward reached for his second pistol, and then looking up with surprise, he said:

"Why, I lost one of my weapons. Ah! I remember where we stopped, *about two miles back*, in the brush, by the river's side. Elsler, you have not ridden as far to-day as I have; won't you ride back and get it for me. You probably will find it on the ground where I was sitting. We will ride slow, so that you can easily overtake us."

"With pleasure, captain," replied Elsler, as he turned his horse, and rode rapidly away.

"I would go with you, captain," said Hayward, "were it not that I have important information to impart to General Price. By the by, captain, is my friend Branch with you now?"

"Yes—but you must have been absent some time not to be aware of his presence."

"Oh! I have not been with the general since the Lexington affair. I just came up from McIntosh's command. But why would I be particularly aware of his presence. Has Branch got himself into trouble?"

"Yes—he's caught a tartar!"

"Will a duel be the result?" asked Hayward, with apparent solicitude.

"Oh! he's already shot!"

"Injured badly?"

"O! no, that is, not mortally. He was only shot, as Mercutio says, 'with a white wench's black eye.' That's all."

"I don't exactly understand you," replied Hayward, feigning ignorance.

"Why, you see, Branch took a young gal prisoner, and has kept her in camp some time. At first he was harsh and done just about as he pleased—that is, he said about what he pleased. But he never couldn't come near the gal. She struck him once with a dagger when he tried to kiss her, and nearly killed him. During the time he was sick he fell in love in real earnest with the gal, and now she does anything she pleases, *except* leave. That she can't do, as Branch has detailed a guard to watch her, and although they are just as much in love with her as Branch is, they dare not let her escape."

"Indeed! She must be a fascinating creature. Is she in camp now?"

"Oh, yes; she has a tent to herself."

"What is her name?"

"I believe they call her Alibamo."

"She is a Spanish beauty, then?"

"That is her Christian name. But I believe she *is* of Spanish origin."

"I must see this beauty," said Hayward, laughing.

"You had better look out for your heart."

"Oh! no danger. I am not susceptible. Here is a young gentleman who is, however. How is it, Harry, do you think *you* will love this—this—what is her name?"

"Alibamo."

"Alibamo! Yes—soft—musical—poetical. Will you love Alibamo, Harry?"

"Very likely, captain," replied the adjutant.

"Well, we must proceed. Good-by, captain. I hope you will secure the powder!"

The parties now separated, Captain Hayward and his friends riding leisurely forward, until the others were no longer to be seen.

"I guess he'll git that powder over the left," said Nettleton, grinning a smile that reminded one of a large hole in the mountain.

"Search for your revolver, captain. *Perhaps* you have not lost it at all."

"I brought but *one*, and that is here. But never mind."

In the course of a few hours, the captain rode into a thick cluster of oaks, followed by his friends.

The horses were secured in a position where they were entirely concealed from view. The negro was instructed to watch them, and the others were to remain quiet until the return of Captain Hayward, provided he should return by twelve o'clock the following night. If not, they were to act as they thought best.

CHAPTER V.

*Hayward in Camp—The Spies—The Maiden Alibamo—The Interview
with Price—The Perilous Situation.*

Columbia's sons! the heavens above us
Sent angels of glory, who brought down our stars!
With part of heaven's blue
Which they gave Washington,
And through him to you,
When first you begun
To form our proud standard. Then lacking the bars,
Columbia's daughters exclaimed, "Those who love us
Must add to that portion with streams of their blood,
Binding it to the blue and the stars, though a flood
Be required." * * * * * *Colonel Weeks.*

It was about ten o'clock in the morning when Captain Hayward left his friends, and proceeded toward the camp of General Price, which was about four miles from the spot where the horses had been secured and the party concealed. Several of the picket guard were passed, who came at once to the shoulder arms and salute, as Hayward approached. He soon reached the guard-house. Here the inspection was a trifle more critical, although the captain passed within the lines without the slightest difficulty. He walked along as one familiar with the place, his eyes surveying each surrounding object at a single glance, and seeking, among the better class of tents, one which, by the rebel flag, he could recognize as headquarters. But he could not readily find the general's tent, concealed, as it was, among the trees. Soon, however, he met one of the rebels, wearing the shoulder-straps of captain, and his sash worn in the manner indicating an "officer of the day." Hayward saluted, and asked:

"Will you take me to the general's tent?"

"You are a stranger here?" asked the officer.

"Yes."

"You come from below?"

"From below Springfield—from McIntosh."

"Anything important?"

"Yes, but it is for the general's ear first. If *he* chooses to communicate with you, very well; but I shall not!"

"Oh! your pardon, sir. You will find the general's tent to the right, on the hill yonder, just in the edge of the woods. He is now examining a spy—an Indian!"

Hayward saluted the officer, and passed on toward the spot indicated. He had proceeded but a short distance, when he saw an Indian dart from among the trees, and run as if for life. Several shots were instantly fired after him, but without effect. It was but an instant before several horsemen appeared, and dashed after him at a furious speed. They passed Hayward, and were soon out of sight.

Hayward passed on, and soon reached the general's tent. He was informed by an orderly in attendance that Price had just left in pursuit of the Indian spy who had just escaped, and might be absent some time.

"These red devils are slippery as eels," said the orderly, "and I doubt if they can overtake him."

"Well, I am in no particular hurry," replied Hayward. "I come from McIntosh with messages for the general, and I will await his return here."

"Then you are a stranger in our camp?"

"Yes, I have just arrived!"

"Well, sit down. Take a cigar—and here is some excellent brandy. Help yourself."

"You appear to be well provided for," said Hayward, lighting a cigar.

"Better with drink than anything else. But I can offer you something to eat, such as it is."

"Thank you, orderly; but I was well supplied at a farm-house this morning. However, I will drink with you. Fill, and we will drink to the general, and success to our cause!"

"I will drink that in a pint bumper," said the orderly, as he drained his glass.

"That is excellent," said Hayward.

"Take another."

"I don't care if I do!"

"Still another!"

"I don't care if I do!" replied Hayward again, in a singular tone.

"Oh! you have been with McIntosh, sure," said the Orderly, who made himself very familiar with his new acquaintance. He had evidently been already very familiar with the brandy, and was getting very drunk. "I should know you had drank with Mac many a time. That is always his reply, and we use it all over the camp—Don't care if I do," and the orderly drained his glass again. Hayward pretended to drink.

"What news do you bring from Mac?" asked the orderly.

"I expect it is advice to retreat!"

"Oh! he need not have sent us that advice!"

"Why, I thought General Price had determined to make a stand here!"

"So did I. But he won't now. Mum's the word, you know, if I tell you!"

"Oh! yes, mum!" answered Hayward in a confidential tone.

"Well, you see, the general sent out spies several days ago, and he thought they were taken, or had played him false, because they didn't come back. But they did come this morning while the general was absent, and brought

these papers. The general was so busy examining the Indian, that he did not see them, and I forgot to tell him they were here."

"What do the papers contain?"

"A plan of the federal camp—the names and description of all the principal officers, even General Fremont, and their entire force in round numbers—their guns—kind of rifle which the infantry use, and, in fact, all the particulars, even to where they post their pickets."

"Orderly, do you think we can successfully contend with their army?"

"I *know* we cannot! They have more fighting men than we, and are much better armed."

"What shall you do, orderly, if Price does make up his mind to fight?"

"You won't betray me?"

"Not if you tell me in confidence."

"Well, then, before the fight begins, *I* shall run like the devil, and get out of the way. Those d——d abolitionists don't take me prisoner, if I can help it!"

"Then you are convinced Price would be whipped?"

"I *know* it!"

"I am of your opinion, orderly. But Price has determined to fight. He has great confidence in his position here, and thinks that he can whip twice his number. Let mo look at those papers!"

The orderly passed the papers to Hayward.

"Now, let me tell you, orderly, *I* think it is all folly for Price to meet the federal army, even if he has a strong position. You know they have sixty—some say eighty thousand men, and four hundred big guns—and yet Price thinks he can successfully meet—What do I see! Why, this paper states that the federal forces only number thirty or thirty-five thousand, and that they have less than two hundred guns! Oh! this is a mistake. Those men who brought this information, I will swear, are Union spies, and are deceiving General Price, merely to get him to fight. Now, I *know* the federals have

more men than represented here, and if Price has determined to meet them with their sixty thousand what will he do if led to believe there are only thirty thousand? Why, he would advance at once and lead us all to death."

"What shall we do?" asked the orderly, evidently alarmed.

"Why, Price *must not see these papers!*"

"How can it be prevented?"

"Let me keep them!"

"But the spies are down at their tent, and as soon as the general comes, they will return and tell him all."

"How many are there?"

"Only two!"

"They must not be permitted to deceive the general, and lead us all to certain destruction. Have them arrested at once, and put them in the outer guard-house—stay, and to prevent their communicating this false information to the men—as it would soon reach Price—have them gagged!"

"I will!" replied the orderly. He left the tent, and soon returned, saying:

"They seemed somewhat surprised when I told them they were found out. But they are properly attended to."

"I do not think that our general's position here is as strong as he thinks it to be. Have you a drawing of his defences?"

"Oh! yes," replied the orderly. "Here is one I drew for my own gratification."

"I will examine it at my leisure," remarked Hayward, as he glanced over the paper, and then placed it in his pocket. "But, now be very careful and make no mention of this matter to Price. What is that?"

"That singing?"

"Yes—that is an extraordinary voice, and is that of a female!"

"Oh! yes—that is a captive bird. But, if you will walk in that direction, I will introduce you to Captain Branch, and perhaps you can get an opportunity to converse with her."

Captain Hayward and the orderly left the tent, and proceeded in the direction from which the sound emanated. At last Hayward paused and said:

"By heaven, that will never do; she is singing the Star-spangled Banner!"

"Oh! she *will* do just what she pleases, in spite of any of us. You had better not say anything to her against that song, or you will get more of her tongue than will be agreeable to your feelings."

They paused before the tent, around which were lounging a number of officers. The orderly introduced Hayward to Captain Branch, and said:

"The gentleman is somewhat curious to see your beauty."

"He shall be gratified. Walk in, sir!"

Both Branch and Hayward entered the tent, and many of the officers crowded around to witness the introduction.

"Alibamo—darling—allow me to present you to a friend—an officer in our army."

"*Present* me anywhere, and to any one, and I will rejoice, if they will only take their presence out of my sight," replied the maiden. Then turning to Hayward she said:

"Pardon me, sir. I did not intend to be rude to you!"

"I have nothing to pardon, sweet lady," replied Hayward kindly. "Speak plainly. I admire candor, and never wish to constrain the speech of any one—more especially a lady, and one so beautiful!"

And beautiful she was, indeed. Her form was almost fairy-like. Her golden tresses fell upon a neck of spotless purity—her cheeks so clear that you could almost see the soul shine through them, leaving its tinge of beauty; and those eyes looked as if they opened first in heaven, and caught their brightness from a seraph's gaze, as flowers are fairest where the sunbeams

fall. But, when she turned that gaze upon you, one could not fail to discover an expression of determination and firmness which could scarcely be expected in one so gentle in appearance.

"You are inclined to flatter," she answered, with a smile. "But if you are so willing others should express their sentiments without restraint, I may hope you were not offended because I was singing a favorite song of mine when you entered my tent."

"Not at all, dear lady. I should be pleased to listen to it again."

"Would you? Then you shall be gratified!"

And Alibamo, seizing her guitar, began the song. As she proceeded, an almost deathly silence was maintained by those around.

What was the meaning of this silence—this apparent thoughtfulness? Why did not the rebel hordes *compel* this female to cease her song of treason to them! Ah! the good old times, when their fathers and our own were fighting side by side, in freedom's holy name, and under the Union banner's folds, came freshly to the mind and heart of each, and caused them to long for just such times again, and for the glorious prosperity which was enjoyed by our country, while that "Star-spangled Banner" waved free and glorious. They thought of streams of blood—blood which had, and must still flow, mingled with tears—hot, burning mother's tears.

Perhaps, too, they were thinking of their own homes, prosperous and happy, till traitors arose, and striking down the standard which waved over them, planted in its place a treacherous emblem, reeking with the pollution of a bad cause.

Or, perhaps they were meditating a return to the dear old flag, but feared to do so. Fear that they might not, like the prodigal, be received with open arms, and fear that, in the outset, they would be overpowered and dealt with as mutineers.

Oh! come back, deluded, mistaken sons of freedom's soil! Come back, ye whose fathers shed their blood to consecrate our land to liberty, for ever! Let your base and calculating political leaders deceive you no more! Be no longer tools for their use and to be only used for their aggrandizement!

Come back to the country that loved you and has so long given you its protection! Come, acknowledge your wrong—seek protection under our starry flag, and fight for it. You shall receive its protection, and be once more ranked as the sons of Columbia.

As she ceased singing, she turned to Hayward and said:

"Do you not admire the song?"

"I admire the singer, lady, but you must excuse me if I do not speak with regard to the sentiment, before you."

"You admire candor. Why not express your sentiments before me? You *look* like a gentleman, and I love occasionally to meet a gentleman, even in the rebel ranks."

"No doubt our views are different, lady. But I trust we will not be enemies nevertheless."

"We may not be personal enemies here. But if you will change that uniform you wear, for that of a Union officer, I will promise that we will be friends."

"I could not consistently do so at present, lady!"

"Why not?"

"When my country is in danger, do I not share it? Thus to take this off, would be to endanger myself and my country's cause."

Alibamo gazed at Hayward a moment, but it was met with a look of indifference.

"Yes, you are in danger. You belong to the so-called Southern confederacy, and you, with it, are in danger of destruction. Why not come back to the Union—the glorious *old* confederacy. Why not come back and fight for the cause *your* fathers died to win. Why not fight under the glorious stars and stripes. See *I* wear them as an apron, even here in this rebel camp. And I tore up a confederate flag to make this. The glorious stars and stripes—oh! how I love them. Our fathers gave them to us pure and spotless, their stars glittering brightly, and their stripes waving free. If they *must* be stained, it will be by the blood of our fathers' sons who are fighting to replace them on

every spot where they *have* waved, but by traitorous hands been stricken down. And they will be placed there. They will yet wave over your home and mine!"

"Lady, you will pardon me, but I cannot longer listen to you. If I do not act as I *think* is right, it will be something new for *Harry Hinton*."

Alibamo started. She trembled violently, but recovering her self-possession, she said:

"Mr. *Harry Hinton*, I could not accuse you of dishonor. Forgive me if I have wounded your feelings by being rude. And to show you my esteem for you—that is so far as I can feel esteem for my country's enemy—you may kiss my cheek at parting!"

The gallant captain stepped forward, and taking the lady by the hand, the kiss echoed throughout the tent. But a *very* close observer would have noticed that Hayward kissed the lady *on, or very near*, the ear!

"Adieu! I trust to see you again!" said Alibamo, as Hayward left the tent.

"You are fortunate," remarked the orderly, as he proceeded toward the tent of Price.

"In what particular?" asked Hayward.

"In winning that lady's heart."

"Do you think I have?"

"It is very evident she is smitten with you. Ah! here is the general."

Hayward entered the tent of Price. The general merely looked up, but did not speak.

"I come to you from McIntosh, with information," said Hayward, as he saluted the general.

"Then you are welcome. Be seated, will you drink?"

"I don't care if I do?" answered Hayward, laughing.

"That sounds natural," said Price. "But how is my friend Mac?"

"Well, but very impatient."

"Why is this?"

"I would speak with you alone," said Hayward, glancing toward the orderly, who, without waiting further notice, left the tent.

"We are alone," said the general.

"The message sent is merely a verbal one, and perhaps of no very great importance, as you may have heard it from your own scouts. But, it is this. McIntosh is in constant communication with an officer of the federal army. He is informed through him, that their strength is greatly over estimated by our forces; that their available forces, if compelled to give battle at once, will be less than twenty thousand, and his advice is to meet the enemy at once."

"I cannot meet even twenty thousand!" said Price, despondingly.

"Not in this stronghold?"

"Not even here, as I *must* count the chances of defeat. Should the enemy advance upon us, they will attack us from the rear, thus cutting off communication, and in case of defeat, our situation would not be a pleasant one."

"Of course you will not meet them, unless certain of success. Mac knows the position and strength of the enemy, but was not so fully informed with regard to your situation. He says, if you think retreat advisable, he will meet you at Springfield."

"Are you to return?" asked Price.

"That is as you may direct, general."

"You will return to-morrow, and tell Mac to join me at Cassville. I am not able to get reliable information from Warsaw, and my camp has been filled with the federal spies for the past three days. Two have just escaped this

morning. I know that the bridge at Warsaw is nearly completed, and that the enemy will move in a few days. I shall march to-morrow."

"It will take five or six days to reach Cassville. Shall I tell Mac to meet you immediately on your arrival?"

"Tell him to camp near Wilson's creek, and await orders. If the army of the federals advance as they have done, that is, only one division several days' march ahead, I shall attack them at Springfield. I was a fool that I did not meet them at Warsaw, when they were thus situated."

"Fremont will be in the advance, I suppose?"

"Yes, with his famous body-guard, and the division under Sigel, in all about eight thousand. I long to meet Sigel again, and that famous body-guard."

"I believe the friend of Mac is an officer in a battalion also acting as the body-guard of Fremont."

"What battalion is that?" asked Price.

"I believe they are called the Benton cadets."

"Ah! yes. I am expecting a messenger here every moment, with the description of all the officers attached to Fremont, and among them is a captain belonging to the cadets, whom I am anxious to meet."

"What is his name?" asked Hayward.

"His name is *Harry Hayward*! senior captain of the battalion."

"Why do you wish to meet him more than any other officer?"

"Because I met him once face to face, and he taunted me!"

"Did he know you, general?"

"No, he did not dream who I was."

"Where did you meet him?"

"It was at a farm-house, beyond Warsaw. I was there in disguise. This captain rode up and asked for a cup of water, and as I was standing at the

well, I gave it to him. I asked the strength of the army, and he replied that they were much stronger than there was any occasion for. I asked him if he thought Price would not fight, and he replied that the rebel army might possibly be induced to meet us if they had a decent general, but with such a d—d cowardly old fool as Price for their leader, we should never catch them."

"Would you know him again if you should meet him?" asked Hayward, with apparent indifference.

"I do not think that I should. He had been riding during the whole of that day, and was so completely covered with dust that his features were not visible. But when one of my men returns, he will have his exact description. I instructed him to be particular about this officer."

"How did you ascertain who he was, at the time you met him?"

"While I was conversing with him, the adjutant rode up and handed him a letter. He opened it and threw the envelope on the ground. I picked it up, and thus learned who he was."

The remaining portion of the time, until nine o'clock in the evening, was passed in ordinary conversation. Hayward did not care to show himself about camp. He well knew that the guard-house held two prisoners, bound and gagged by his order, and accused of being spies from the federals, who were in reality rebel spies, and true to their cause. He knew they had both, or at least one of them, seen him, and would recognize him at once. He had his own description in his pocket, written by one of them, which had by the merest chance been prevented from falling into the hands of Price. However, time passed on, and nothing like suspicion was manifested, that Hayward was not just what he represented himself. Nine o'clock came. The countersign was out, which the general readily gave to Hayward. Tattoo had scarcely ceased sounding, when a sergeant appeared at the tent-entrance and said:

"General, one of the prisoners accused of being a spy, wishes to see you. He says his information is of vast importance."

"I know of no person charged with being a spy whom we have as prisoner! But it is possible some of the morning prowlers have been caught."

"He says he came direct from Warsaw where you had sent him."

"Strange!" said Price, musing. "Tell him I will be at the guard-house in an hour. Stay. Bring him to my tent at ten o'clock."

The sergeant departed.

"Will you excuse me a moment?" said Price, turning to Hayward. "I have letters to write."

"Certainly!" said Hayward as he left the tent.

Hayward walked leisurely along, until he reached the outer guard-house. He was here challenged and giving the countersign, passed out. He proceeded rapidly to the place where his friends awaited him, and found them all ready for orders, and for action.

CHAPTER VI.

The Escape—The Pursuit—The Capture.

Charge—charge, boys, for "God and for liberty!" See!
Their traitorous banner is hurled to the ground.
And up go our colors, the "Flag of the Free,"
While our bands strike "Columbia," oh! glorious sound.
Col. Weeks.

"Darn my buttons if the captain ain't got back all safe!" shouted Nettleton, as he fairly danced with delight.

"Yes, all safe," replied Hayward "But how have you passed the day, Adjutant Hinton?"

"Not at all pleasantly!" replied the adjutant. "We have had serious anxiety on your account, and I suppose we came very near being discovered!"

"Indeed! Why so?"

"You had been absent just long enough to reach camp, when we heard the firing of guns. In a short time a party of horsemen rode past at a furious rate, cursing and speaking of a spy. We feared you had been discovered, were making your escape, and that they were in pursuit."

"What did you do?"

"Of course I advised our friends to remain quiet. I thought if we were to appear and fight, you would reach us in some way, or give us some signal. But it was very difficult to restrain Nettleton. He determined to rush upon the pursuers, and once had his gun raised to fire upon them, but I prevented him from doing so."

"I am very much obliged to you for your good feeling, and admire your courage. But, you must not be rash. If you had fired a gun, it would have brought certain destruction upon us all."

"Well, captain, you see I wouldn't have done it, but I was feared that black rascal there would expose us all. The curse began to *cry* just as soon as he heerd the guns shootin', and when they let off that volley up at that rock there, the darned sneak's bones rattled so, I was sure they would hear them."

"But, how have you succeeded, captain?" asked the adjutant.

"Oh! admirably. That party you saw was led by Price himself. He was in pursuit of an Indian. He left camp just as I arrived at his tent, and this gave me just the opportunity I desired. There was no person at the general's tent but an orderly, who became very familiar and communicative. He gave me the exact plan of their encampment, but it will be of little use, as Price takes up his line of march for Cassville to-morrow. But the most important document I possess is the plan of our own camp, containing not only my own description, but I suppose that of yours, and of all the generals, and other principal officers in our army."

"How did you get possession of this document?"

"It was brought to the tent of Price by his spies while he was absent. I learned from the orderly that the general did not know the existence of the paper, or that his spies had returned. So I worked upon the fears of the orderly, got possession of the paper, and his promise not to let Price know anything about it, and then ordered the men who brought it to be put in the guard-house and gagged. Of course I accused them of playing false to Price, and of being in reality Union spies."

"Of course the trick will be discovered!"

"Oh! certainly—and I suppose it is by this time, as one of the prisoners sent for Price, and he was to meet him at ten o'clock. For a short time they will be puzzled. The question will be asked the orderly, what he did with the papers, and he will answer that he gave them to me. But, when Price learns that it was me who ordered his spies under arrest, and gagged so that they could not speak, that I have the papers, that my story to him and the orderly did not agree, and that I am nowhere to be found, he will see at once that he

has been terribly sold, and know that I was a spy. If he describes my person, I will be at once recognized by one of the men whom I had placed under arrest, as the very man Price longed to get in his grasp!"

"Why, what does Price know of you?" asked the adjutant.

"Do you remember our second day's march from Tipton, that about four o'clock in the afternoon, I was stopping at a log-house, near a well, at the right of the road, and that while the person who appeared to be master of the house was helping me to a cup of water, you rode up and gave me a letter?"

"Yes, I remember it perfectly well, and that you remarked the letter was from Mamie."

"Exactly. And do you recollect the words I used about Price, to the man who gave me the water?"

"I remember they were not very complimentary."

"Well, the man who handed me that cup of water was Price himself!"

"The devil! And did he not recognize you to-day?"

"No, for he spoke of Captain Hayward, and remarked that he had an account to settle with him, and had sent for his description, which he expected every moment. I had it in my pocket at the time, and those who took it were under arrest by my order. They would have recognized me in an instant if they had seen me. The reason that Price did not recognize me was, that when he saw me at the well, I was almost black with dust, and I took pains to-day to change the tone of my voice as much as possible."

"It was a terrible risk!"

"By gracious, captain, if you ain't a trump," said Nettleton, as he opened wide his green eyes.

"But they have discovered all by this time, and we have not a moment to lose. It is eleven o'clock now, and you are expected at yonder rock!"

"You have seen Alibamo?"

"Yes, and kissed her!"

"She knew you, then?"

"No—she didn't—I told her before a large crowd that I was Harry Hinton. She understood me, and said I might kiss her. I did so—*on the ear!*"

"And whispered at the same time. Thank you, my best friend."

"Well, don't stop for thanks now. That rock is outside the picket guard, but she will be attended by ten or twelve soldiers. Go to her at once. I will see our horses placed in a position where we can easily mount. The negro shall ride behind Nettleton, and Alibamo shall have White Surry."

"We must fight, of course."

"I think it will not be necessary—that is, only you and I!"

"What do you mean, captain?"

"Why, her guard have all seen you, and by your own story, they think you a lover, although not altogether a favored one. I have met the beauty to-day—they have all seen me. They saw me kiss her, and think, that for a short acquaintance, I am a remarkably favored lover. You are a private, and I am an officer, and in that particular, of course, have the advantage. I will come upon you, after you have conversed a few moments, and take the lady under my protection. Her guard will be much more likely to permit me to walk with the lady alone than you, as I am an officer in favor with the general. Once near our horses, we have nothing to fear, and none of her guard are mounted. Now go Harry. If we must fight, all right."

As Adjutant Hinton started for the rock, Captain Hayward directed that the horses be brought into the main pathway. It was done, and all was in readiness.

As Harry reached the rock, Alibamo sprang forward to receive him.

"Let your action be constrained—do not embrace me—and speak low, dear Alibamo. The reason for this, you will discover presently."

"I know you have good cause for this request, my own Harry, but I must tell you how I love you!" replied Alibamo, as she bowed her head upon the breast of her lover. "But I have been here an hour—and I sang, in the hope you would hear my voice."

Some words of tenderness passed between the lovers, when Alibamo cried:

"What is that?"

It was at this moment that the brother of Alibamo, as narrated in the second chapter, creeping near the rock, had overheard her words, and had cried, "Then you are not my sister!"

"It is my brother! my own brother's voice. He has been near—has heard all!" shrieked Alibamo. Then checking herself, she said, in a low tone: "He thinks you a rebel, Harry! He forswears me! How can I undeceive him?"

"The guard has fired upon him. The camp is aroused—they are beating the long-roll. It is a desperate hazard now!"

"But my brother?"

"Quick—give me your apron—I will wave it—he may see its colors—and sing—sing, Alibamo—sing the Star-spangled Banner!"

Harry seized the apron, and commenced waving it, and Alibamo began to sing.

"Silence!" cried Hayward, who came up at that moment. "Silence that traitorous song. And give me that ensign of abolitionism. For shame, young man. Love has made you blind. Don't you see that the lady's apron which you are waving is a federal flag? It may be very romantic to meet young ladies at midnight on a moonlit-rock, and whisper love-tales; but *you*, sir, must not wave such things as this, merely to conciliate angry brothers. Now, go to camp, sir, and if I catch you at such tricks again, I shall order your arrest. I will take charge of the lady."

"Here are her guard sir," said Harry, in a subdued tone.

"Ah! yes. Are you mounted, boys?"

"No, captain."

"Then get within the lines as soon as possible. The federal army are advancing, and are within a few miles of us, and their scouts are but a short distance from this point. I have a horse, and will make my servant dismount and give the lady his horse!"

"All right, captain," replied the sergeant in command of the squad He had seen Hayward that day several times, and had no doubt he was just what he appeared.

Hayward had brought his own horse and that rode by Nettleton, within a few feet of the spot where he was then standing. The adjutant had already disappeared, as the captain handed the lady into the saddle and mounted his own horse. As he turned into the main road, a mounted orderly from the camp rode up to the squad and asked:

"Have you seen that fellow who was around camp to-day and pretended to be from McIntosh—the one that kissed Alibamo?"

"Yes, there he is, just—why he is going *from* the camp instead of toward it!"

"It is Captain Harry Hayward, of the federal army, and a spy. Fire upon him!"

A discharge of musketry rang through the woods, but the captain and his charge were too well covered by the trees and the darkness to be injured by it.

Captain Hayward heard the question, and striking his horse with the spur, he dashed forward at a rapid rate, followed by the whole party.

"The story I told the guard of the advancing army," said Hayward, "will prevent an immediate pursuit. But Price will know it is not true, and in an hour we shall be hotly followed. We must make the best of our time!"

The company did not pause for more than five hours, as it was daylight when the first halt was made. They had scarcely dismounted when the echoes of horses' feet were heard in the distance.

"We are pursued, but we must press forward. Those sounds cannot be more than a mile in the rear. They must have ridden very rapidly. But we will escape them without difficulty. We cannot be more than ten miles from our outposts, and they will not dare pursue us much farther." They had scarcely prepared to set off again, when Nettleton said:

"There come the skunks that went after the powder!"

It was true. In the opposite direction came the party of twenty. Behind, they were followed by they knew not how large a force, and before, twenty rebels were approaching. Whether they could be so easily misled this time, was a matter of considerable doubt.

"Quick—ride for the wood, Miss Alibamo. You may save yourself—we must fight. Stay! They see you. It will be too late; besides, we met this party once before, and they may not interrupt us at all. That which I fear most is, that they will detain us so long in conversation that the rear party will overtake us. But we must venture."

"They will know me, captain," said Alibamo.

"If a fight is inevitable, Alibamo, do you start for the river. White Surry can swim—he is accustomed to it. Plunge in—give him a loose rein, and he will bear you safely to the opposite shore. Then ride rapidly for camp. They are upon us."

"Well, captain, the army is moving, is it not?" asked Hayward.

"What army?" was the sullen question.

"Why, *our* army moves to-day—or at least the general so informed me; but I speak of the federal army. The general received information last night that Fremont would cross the river to-day at four o'clock. And I was sent to ascertain if this was so!"

"Indeed! And do you usually take women with you when you act as spies?"

"Not usually. But I thought *my wife* could gain admittance to the camp much more easily than a man!"

"Your wife. Bah! Very likely the general would let her go, when he knows she passes half her time singing the Star-spangled Banner, and wears the federal flag as an apron! She would betray us all, and never return."

"Look you, sir!" said Hayward sternly, "I don't intend to hold any argument with you, and I will not listen to any insults or insinuations. I married Alibamo last evening. She was an old friend, and will hereafter adhere Strictly to my cause and adopt my principles. You see, she no longer wears the flag as an apron!"

"I see it!"

"And when approaching the federal camp, do you suppose she would take it off, unless it was of her own accord?"

"I don't know. But I *do* want to know about that powder. When we got there, we found the powder gone, and a squad ready to receive us. We had to swim the river to get away, and, as it was, two of our own party were killed. Hello! There comes another party, headed by Branch. It may be all right, but d——n me if I don't hold you till they come up, because I believe you are nothing more nor less than abolition spies, and that the man you sent back after your revolver, went direct to Fremont and informed about the powder!"

He had scarcely finished these words, when Nettleton's gun came crashing on his head, and the brains flew in every direction. He fell from his horse, dead. The attack now commenced in earnest, but it had been so sudden on the part of the attacking party, that eleven of the rebels bit the dust before the party had sufficiently recovered from surprise to make any effective defence.

"Quick, Alibamo; to the river—save yourself—they are upon us!" shouted Hayward.

The first attacking party had been entirely scattered by the lightning blows dealt by the little Union band, but, as they saw the approach of at least fifty other horsemen, they rallied for another charge. The horses of Hayward and his party were worn and jaded—so were those of his pursuers, while those of the fallen foe were fresh.

"Spring into the saddles of those fresh horses—ride for your lives—quick!"

It was accomplished in an instant. The approaching party were now only a few yards from the devoted band, when a shot was fired, and with a groan Captain Hayward fell to the ground. In an instant, Adjutant Hinton was by his side.

"Captain—O God!—captain-speak!" he cried. "Are you hurt?"

"Here—these papers—take them—go—go—save yourself!"

"Never—never!" he cried. "Come on, ye fiends—I will sell my life dearly—I will die with my captain!"

"No—no! Alibamo—save her—those papers—go, I command—I am mortally hurt—save yourselves—you cannot benefit me!"

"You may live!"

"Then go, and return to *rescue me*—oh!" And Hayward spoke no more.

"Or to avenge your death!" cried Hinton, as he sprang into his saddle and darted from the spot, amid a shower of bullets, bearing the papers with him.

In an instant Hayward was surrounded, but they could not overtake the flying party, who had the advantage of fresh horses.

CHAPTER VII.

The Brother—The War Scout—The Union Camp—The Trail.

Find them—bring them back—then ask for millions.

Old Play.

When William Margrave, the brother of Alibamo, had been discovered, and fired upon by the guard, after having seen his sister, and heard her voice, he knew that his assistance would be of no avail. He at once started for the cabin where were his friends Johnson and Fall-leaf, but not until he had seen Alibamo mount her horse, and, with her friend, dash forward from the camp. He saw the soldiers as they fired after the retreating form of his sister and her friend, and also saw that they were unhurt.

"It is a rescue; still, I cannot understand it—I cannot conceive how she came to meet friends from the Union army, or how they became aware of her presence in the rebel camp."

He pursued his course to the river, and crossing, soon reached the cabin. As he entered, Johnson rose to receive him.

"Your return is sudden. What has happened?" he asked.

"All for the best!"

"Explain."

"It was my sister's voice that I heard I saw her—I spoke to her."

"Could you not save her?"

"I would have done so, or died by her side. But she had other friends with her. I saw her with two men, one of them disguised as a rebel officer. Or, at least, so I suppose, for he led her to a horse, helped her to mount, and rode rapidly away, while the guard who had just come up, fired after them. She is on her way to the Union camp, and will reach it in a short time, if nothing happens."

"Are you sure those who rescued her were Union soldiers?"

"I can only judge by what I saw."

"What do you intend doing?"

"How is Fall-leaf?" asked Margrave.

"Me well—well!" answered the Indian.

"Why, how is this? I thought Fall-leaf was badly wounded."

"No! his wounds are slight. That in his breast or side, is merely a flesh-wound. The shot struck a rib, and glanced off. A second shot struck him near the temple, and stunned him. But he is not seriously injured."

"Can he walk?"

"Me walk—well!" replied Fall-leaf, as he arose and strode across the room.

"Then we must go at once to the federal camp. Can you walk so far, Fall-leaf?"

"Me go down—horse—there!"

"He has a horse concealed among the trees, but a short distance down the river, and on this side," replied Johnson.

"Have you never entertained any suspicion that my sister was with Price?"

"Oh, yes. But Price has never placed any confidence in me, and never, except at this last visit, have I been permitted to enter, or leave camp, without the presence of a guard."

"Well, let us be off. We must keep on this side of the river to avoid scouts."

The party walked down to the bank of the Osage, and striking a narrow path, took their course toward Warsaw. The Indian secured his horse, and mounting, rode by the side of his friends.

It was late in the afternoon when they reached the Union camp. The first thing Margrave did upon his arrival was to acquaint the general with all the particulars, and requested to be shown those officers or soldiers who had that day returned from the rebel camp, in the hope of finding his sister. He was directed to Adjutant Hinton, and with a beating heart he sought his presence. He found the adjutant in deep grief, but he arose to receive him.

"Why, you are the officer whom I saw standing upon the rock with my sister," said Margrave.

"Then you are the brother of Alibamo?"

"I am."

"Do you know where she is?"

"Where she is?" echoed Margrave, with surprise. "Why, I came here to learn where she is!"

"Ah! yes. Well, my friend, I am deeply distressed with regard to your sister. She should have been here before this."

"Why, did she not leave with you?"

"She started with myself and friends, but we were met by overwhelming numbers about ten miles from this place, and a terrible fight ensued. Our captain was killed, or very badly wounded, and our party scattered. I saw Alibamo riding for the river, intending to swim her horse across it. The captain fell, and I turned to rescue him. He was nearly gone, but told me to save myself and Alibamo. That name acted like a magic, and, coward that I was, I left my captain, and sought her. But, I could not find her—neither any of my friends. I returned to camp alone! Oh! my God, if I had only remained, and died with them!"

George, the negro, now entered the tent. His countenance was the very index of terror.

"George, are they alive?" almost shrieked the adjutant.

"Oh! yes—yes—Gor a mighty, massa adjutump—day's fifty ob em!"

The adjutant saw the negro was too much frightened to give any correct account, and he tried to reassure him.

"You are safe now. Nothing can harm you here."

"Sartin shuah ob dat, massa adjutump?"

"Sure, George. But now tell me what you know of our friends."

"Oh! golly massa adjutump, dis chile neber was so skeered. Dar was fifty."

"Where is Captain Hayward!"

"Killed—dead—shuah pop—oh! golly!"

"Where is Captain Young?"

"He's here, massa adjutump."

Captain Young entered the tent.

"You are alive; but where are our friends?" asked the adjutant.

"I know not, I lost sight of them, and supposed them all killed but myself."

"George, where is Nettleton?"

"I dun know. De las time dis chile see Cap'n Nettletum he jump his hos in the riber after de gal, O Lord!"

"What became of the lady, George?"

"Oh! golly! massa adjutump, she's safe wid de rebels!"

"What do you mean?"

"Why, ye see, massa adjutump, when dis chile see de cap'n fall down dead, he was so skeered he tumble rite off his horse. So I creep into de bushes, and just as de gal she got to de riber, a big black debil he cotch hold on her an say, 'Ha! ha! now I got hold on you, my booty,' and den he tuck her off an dis chile didn't see her no more."

"She is again in the hands of the rebels, and we must again rescue her, even if it costs a thousand lives. Oh! wretch—wretch that I am—I have murdered my captain, and have not saved her!"

"Please don't, massa adjutump!"

"Don't what?"

"Why, don't take dis chile wid you any more. He get killed, shuah."

"Don't be alarmed. I don't want you."

"Me go see—me follow," said the Indian.

"Go where?"

"After pale-face!"

"How can you ascertain which way they have taken her?"

The Indian made the motion of creeping on the ground. Then he stamped it with his foot, and pointed to the mark. Johnson said:

"He means he will go to the river where Alibamo was seized, take the measure of the horse's shoe, from its impression in the sand, and follow the trail. We will go with him—that is myself and Alibamo's brother."

"I must go. But stay. Nettleton has not yet returned, I have great confidence in that fellow. He may bring us intelligence."

"You had better remain here in the event of his return," said Margrave. "We will follow the trail, and when we have gained the information we require, we will let you know, and you may be able to assist us."

"We are to march to-morrow for Springfield. Price moves to-day for Cassville, and if Alibamo is again in the hands of that wretch, Branch, she will probably be removed to that place. But go, and success attend you."

The two friends, together with Fall-leaf, left the camp, and proceeded in the direction of the place where the skirmish occurred. In the course of two hours they reached the spot. Several of the dead still were upon the field, unburied, but no sign of any human being was visible, excepting these. The Indian sought for traces upon the river's bank, and discovering a spot where an evident struggle had taken place—where *two* horses had been turned around, and had proceeded on their way *from* the river at a much slower pace than *toward* it, judging from the length of the steps. These tracks were closely followed, and it was observed that they soon merged into others, and could no longer be distinguished. The course of the entire squadron of cavalry was *toward* the camp of Price, and it was decided, that the reason the first discovered marks of the horse's shoe could no longer be seen was, that they were in the lead, and those which followed obliterated the

impression. And it was reasonable to suppose that Branch and Alibamo would ride at the head of the column.

The friends followed the trail until it turned to the left, and took its direction across the mountain. Upon the other side it was lost to view in the main road, among the thousand tracks which appeared in the mud. But they had seen sufficient to satisfy them that not only this squad, but the entire army under Price were on their retreat. They determined to follow on, and, if possible, to rescue Alibamo, and if this could not be done, to get exact information as to where she was kept, and then to return for assistance.

CHAPTER VIII.

The Prisoners—Brutality—The Attendant—The Letter—Discovery.

What bloody man is that? He can report
As seemeth by his plight, of the revolt
The newest state.—*Shakespeare.*

As Branch saw the prostrate form of Hayward upon the ground, he cried:

"By heavens, it is the very man we want—it is Captain Hayward!"

"Ride over his body—trample him into the earth!" shouted one of the infuriated soldiers.

"No! no!" shrieked Branch. "If he yet lives he must be reserved for torture! It is our general's command. Let no one dare to disobey it. Ah! the fiends befriend me! There is Alibamo, and her horse has fallen!"

This was indeed true. In her haste as she dashed down the steep toward the river, the horse of Alibamo had missed his footing, and fallen, throwing its fair rider violently to the ground. It was but an instant before he was again upon his feet, but before Alibamo could regain her seat, her persecutor had seized her.

"Ah! my fair beauty," he cried, "I have you once more in my grasp. And now revenge will be a thousand times sweeter. Look there!" he cried, as he dragged the helpless girl forward. "Look upon your would-be rescuer! It is a glorious spectacle, is it not?"

"Dead! dead!" sobbed the maiden.

"Ah! you weep for him, do you? No doubt you love him very dearly! But he is *not* dead, and I would not have him dead for millions! It was a game well played, and worthy of your lover, the gallant Captain Hayward. But he did

not win the game. *I* held the trump card, and I will show him how I won, and *why* I won, when he recovers!"

"What would you do?"

"What would I do? *You* shall see. First I will let him return to consciousness, and then I'll tear him limb from limb—hack him to pieces—tear out that heart you love so much, and give it to you still beating with life, and dripping with his blood. You shall wear it ever before you, and it will be a reminder of my generosity!"

"Oh! fiend! fiend!" groaned Alibamo.

"Oh! yes! You have called me fiend a hundred times, and now you shall learn that I am one, indeed. Shout, boys! shout! We are victorious! Dance—dance—hold your revels over that form! But do not harm it more now. I would have him *all* to myself. And I'll pray that he may have a thousand lives!"

The rebels readily obeyed the command of Branch, and commenced their howlings.

"Hark to that music, Alibamo. It is our notes of victory. Do you not love those sounds?"

"They become only such as you. The most barbarous savage would scorn to exult thus over a single fallen foe!" said Alibamo, her eyes flashing with indignation.

"Oh! taunt! I love to hear it. It makes my hatred for your captain deeper. And for every word of insult you have spoken, or do speak to me, I'll revenge myself on him. And you shall see it all. See, he moves—he opens his eyes! Let him gaze around."

"Harry! Harry!" called Hayward in a faint voice.

"Oh! my beauty, he does not speak your name first! But perhaps he hopes for assistance. He shall have it soon!"

"Mamie—Mamie—sister—closer to my heart. I'm cold—co——" The sound died upon his lips.

"And hark, yours is not the second name he speaks. He has a sister whom he loves. And I will have *her* too! *She* shall be in my power—oh! I will wring his heart. Oh! I cannot speak my exultant joy. My very heart is burning within me as I see before me this glorious prospect for revenge."

"You are foiled in that, villain that you are. His sister is far beyond your reach, in the bosom of her Northern home."

"But I'll find her—I'll have her in my power merely to torture him if it costs me millions. Don't let him die. Tear open his vest—see where he is wounded, and wash it with liquor—it will prolong his life."

Some of the soldiers did as they were bid.

"There is a letter. Give it me. Ah! by the Eternal! 'tis signed, '*your loving sister, Mamie!*' And here is the name of her home. Now, Alibamo, what say you? Is she not in my power? And not only she, but all his family shall suffer. I hate the tribe. You said I could not find her. I'll write to-night and tell her that her brother is wounded and wishes her presence at once. She will come, and she shall see me torture him!"

"What benefit or gratification will that afford you, Branch?" asked Alibamo.

"Why, this is a tender epistle. This Hayward loves his sister, and if she is gazing upon his pangs, it will be doubly keen to him, knowing she sees it. He will feel all her sufferings and his own. Ah! Hayward speaks again!"

"Alibamo! Alibamo!"

"Stop his mouth—tear his tongue out. He shall not speak your name."

Branch struck the fallen man across his face with his heavy iron scabbard. The blood spirted from his mouth and nostrils, but he moved not. As the soldiers applied the fluid to his wounds, Hayward showed evidence of pain, but did not speak.

"The ball has passed directly under the right arm, and must have entered the lungs. He will not live," said one of the soldiers.

"He shall live!" cried Branch. "He *must* live. Tie him on one of the horses and let us be off."

This order was obeyed promptly. It seemed as if the fiend which urged on the actions of that bad man, had, from very shame, left his breast, and he silently took the lead, and with Alibamo by his side, the squadron set off at a rapid rate.

For many miles they kept on their course toward the camp of the rebels. At length they turned their direction across the mountain. As they ascended to the summit, Alibamo asked:

"Whither are you going, Branch?"

"Look yonder. Don't you see the army moving. It is our army. We are going to Springfield."

"You are retreating like cowards as you are!" replied Alibamo, with a sneer.

The only reply from Branch was a blow upon the head of the senseless captain.

"Thus will I revenge every word of insult you speak to me!"

"You will revenge but little more, for he is nearly gone. But you are mistaken if you deem him my lover. I never saw him until to-day."

"I do not believe you," replied Branch.

"Did you not hear him speak the name of Harry Hinton?"

"I did."

"Harry is the one I love. Captain Hayward spoke that name that I might recognize him as a friend. Harry was with the captain, and has escaped, and wo to you, Branch, when he returns!"

"Bah! Think you that I can be frightened from my purpose? No! Besides, I do not believe one word you have said. Has Hayward spoken recently?" asked Branch.

"Yes, several times. But he is evidently suffering great pain from riding in this manner, and he faints in an instant after the return of his reason," replied one of the soldiers.

"O Branch! in mercy do not torture this poor man in this manner," said Alibamo, imploringly.

"We will overtake an ambulance in an hour, and then I will transfer him to one of them."

"May I be permitted to attend upon him?" asked Alibamo.

"Would it be a great gratification to you?"

"Oh! yes; very great!"

"Then you shan't. Now speak of him no more."

In a short time an ambulance was overtaken, and Branch said:

"Place Hayward in that ambulance. If he is carried on horseback, he will die, and I shall lose my revenge!"

"Let me handle the *darn skunk*!" said one of the party, as he advanced through the crowd. "I'm used to handlin' just such darned skunks as he is!"

"Be careful!" said Branch, as this peculiar looking object lifted Hayward from the horse.

"Oh! guess there's no occasion to be too careful. Such dam skunks as him ain't so easy killed."

Hayward was placed in the ambulance.

"Who will volunteer to remain with him?" asked Branch.

No one replied.

"Will you?" asked Branch, turning to the person who had volunteered to assist Hayward from his horse.

"Well, yes—that is if nobody else won't. But I don't like such work very much."

"And let six mounted guard march behind. I will go forward and report to the general. Here, Peters, take charge of Alibamo until I return."

Matters thus arranged, Branch rode forward. The army proceeded but a few miles farther. In a short time after the halt, Branch returned and riding up to the ambulance, he asked of the attendant:

"How is the captain?"

"He is asleep, and seems to breathe much easier, the darn skunk!"

"Has he spoken at all?"

"No; I did not wake him!"

"Take him around to the tent of the general," said Branch, addressing the driver.

"Ay, ay, sir!"

"Shall I go along?" asked the attendant.

"Yes, you may attend upon him for the present. Treat him well, as I wish him to recover."

"Oh! I'm a kind o' doctor, and I'll do the best I can by him," was the reply.

In a short time Hayward was brought to the tent of Price.

"Is he conscious?" asked the general.

"No!"

"Place him in that vacant tent, and let a surgeon attend him. It is highly important that he should live. Have you searched him for papers?"

"Not yet!"

"Let him be searched, and bring me whatever you find!" said Price.

The search was made, but nothing of the character desired by Price was found upon his person.

Hayward was removed to the tent indicated by Price. A surgeon was soon in attendance, and after dressing his wounds, announced that with the proper attention, Hayward would recover.

"If he becomes thoroughly conscious before morning, and is able to converse, let me know it. I wish to question him," said Price, as he left the wounded captain in charge of the guard.

As Price was entering his tent, an orderly presented him with a letter. The general tore it open, and glanced over its contents. He said:

"The lady asks the privilege of attending upon the wounded captain. Let her do so, but give instructions that if Hayward returns to consciousness, not one word is to pass between him and the lady, except in presence of the guard. And to prevent any conversation which may be understood by themselves, and not by the guard, let every word spoken by them be noted. Place four sentinels outside the tent, and one will remain within."

"Your orders shall be strictly carried out, general."

"If he again escape, those guarding him shall answer for it with their lives."

"I will answer for his safety with mine," replied the orderly, as he departed.

He proceeded at once to the tent of Alibamo, and informed her that she was at liberty to attend upon Hayward for the present, but that every word spoken between them was to be reported. Branch was with her, and when he heard this, he tore his hair from very rage.

"This general is too soft-hearted!" muttered Branch to himself. "But come, Alibamo, I will go with you to Hayward's tent!"

"I prefer to go without you, sir!" was the reply.

"No doubt—and for that very reason I am going with you!"

They soon reached the tent, and Alibamo seated herself beside the wounded man. Branch took his seat opposite.

"Do you intend to remain here?" asked Alibamo.

"I am not welcome, I suppose?" replied Branch with sarcasm.

"I would prefer the tent should be filled with serpents?"

Branch frowned terribly, and bit his lips, but did not reply.

"Why don't you strike this senseless man, and thus revenge that honest, truthful answer?" asked Alibamo.

"If you speak thus again, I will do so!"

"Not while I am here. Soldier, hand me that knife!" But before she had finished the sentence, she had snatched the knife alluded to, from the belt of the attendant.

"You know, Branch, I used a weapon of this sort to some purpose, once, and if you dare approach me, or this helpless officer, I will drive it to your heart."

"Recover your knife!" cried Branch, who was now fairly foaming with rage, to the attendant.

"Just you hand over that tool, you darn skunk, you!" said the soldier, as he arose, and advanced toward Alibamo.

"Stand back, sir. Stand back. I do not wish to harm you, soldier, but if you attempt to take this weapon from me, you will feel its point."

"Captain," said the soldier, "there ain't no use in trying to make *women* mind you. They're darn skunks any way—better let 'em alone."

"Hayward is awake!" said Branch. "Speak to him—see if he will reply."

"Captain, do you know me?" asked Alibamo.

A faint smile overspread the captain's face, but he did not reply.

"Can you not speak? Oh! let me hear your voice once more! Say at least, that you forgive me—for I have brought all this upon you!" Alibamo bent over the wounded man, weeping as if her heart would break. Hayward closed his eyes, and did not reply.

"What the devil are *you* blubbering about?" growled Branch addressing himself to the attendant soldier.

"Cos I'm a darn skunk," sobbed the attendant, scarcely able to speak.

"My good friend, do you sympathize with this noble captain?"

"Yes—yes—ma'am," sobbed the soldier. "I don't believe he's half so much of a darn skunk as some other folks!"

"There, don't weep," said Alibamo, in a soothing manner, as she laid her hand gently upon his arm. "I am glad to meet one good heart here!"

"Don't—don't, Miss Alibamo. There's something inside of me that's swelling up, and if you talk that way, I know it will burst, and I shall bellow like a bull. Oh! I wish I wasn't such a darn skunk! But I ain't no account, no way, so don't call me a good heart, cos nobody ever said that to me afore, only cap—— only you, and I ain't nothing but a cowardly skunk!"

"Why have you so much sympathy for your enemy?" asked Branch.

"Because I don't think it's fair to strike a man when he's down!"

"I'll tell you, Branch," said Alibamo, "why he has so much sympathy for the captain—a feeling you cannot understand. God has given him a noble heart, and he can feel for the unfortunate, even though it be an enemy."

"Did you ever see Hayward before!" asked Branch of the soldier, eying him sharply.

"I seed him in the fight. Lord didn't he make his sword fly. More than a dozen sojers lay down when he hit 'em. It made my hair stand up, I tell you. By thunder, *wasn't* he brave! I'll bet if there had been six just like him, he'd licked our crowd. If he is a dam skunk of a federal, he is a trump card it'll do to go a big pile on."

"Give me—water!" said Hayward, in a feeble voice, opening his eyes.

"Quick, some water," said Alibamo. She placed the cup to his lips, and he drank.

"I have been dreaming!" said Hayward. "Oh! it was sweet!"

"Of what did you dream?" asked Alibamo.

"Of home—Mamie—Mamie!"

"He is conscious. His answer was direct," said Branch.

"Do you know me, captain?" asked Alibamo.

"Yes—where is Harry?"

"He is not here!"

"I want him—I feel sick! Call him. William Nettleton!" called Hayward, in a low tone.

"Here, captain!—Won't—won't I do just as well? I'll do anything I can for you," said the attendant, springing forward. Had the rebel officer been less absorbed in the prisoner's state he must surely have observed the agitation of the attendant.

"Do you know where you are?" asked Branch of Hayward.

The captain had closed his eyes, but upon hearing the voice of Branch, he opened them, and looked upon the speaker—a look so full of scorn and disgust as to betray the lion heart still beating in his breast.

"Why is that man in my tent?" he asked. "Take him away—his presence is hateful to me."

"It will be before I am through with you. What is that?"

"One of the sentinels in the rear of this tent has discharged his piece!"

"Some of your friends are after us, very likely, Alibamo. I will call upon them, perhaps I shall be able to bring you company." Branch left the tent, hurriedly and not without trepidation.

A gleam of light lit up the face of the attendant. He became at once uneasy. Then he sprang suddenly to the ground, exclaiming, but not loudly:

"There was a hand there. It held a bit of paper!"

Alibamo sprang forward, and seized the paper which was lying on the ground. She held it to the light, and then exclaimed aloud, as if unconscious of what she said:

"It is my brother's writing—friends are near!" Then, as if suddenly recollecting herself, she turned to the attendant and said:

"Oh! do not betray me, I beg—I implore!"

"I ain't no such darn skunk. Let me tell you something."

The attendant spoke in a whisper. Alibamo started, clasped his hand, kissed it convulsively. "Dear, good fellow!" she said through her tears.

"There—oh! don't—O Christopher!—I shall have to blubber, and then all will be up with us!" cried the fellow, as he twisted and hopped around the tent like one suffering pain.

CHAPTER IX.

The Friends—The Proposal—The Rejection—The Fate.

'Tis sweet to die for one's country!—*Old Maxim.*

The alarm caused by the firing of the gun had entirely subsided, as nothing was discovered. Upon questioning the guard, he stated that he was suddenly seized, and thrown violently to the ground. But, before he could recover his surprise and fire, the form had disappeared among the trees. Some believed that spies were lurking about camp, while others attributed the alarm entirely to the imagination or fear of the guard.

The morning dawned, bright and beautiful. Hayward had entirely returned to consciousness; but was unable to converse, and appeared to notice nothing which transpired around him. He did not even speak to, or recognize, his fair attendant, Alibamo. At times his words were of home—his friends were called upon—and then he would remain silent.

The army took up its line of march. Hayward was transported as before, and at each night was kindly cared for by Alibamo and the other attendant, who still were permitted to remain with him. At last they reached the grand prairie, west of Springfield, and encamped for the night.

"Is Captain Hayward sufficiently recovered to converse?" asked Price of Branch.

"Oh! yes; he is rapidly recovering. His wound is not so serious as at first supposed. It is true he is quite weak from loss of blood, but still strong enough to be dangerous. It is my advice that he be removed from the main army, as his friends will spare no trouble to rescue him. We are to have a battle very soon, I suppose, and we may lose him, even if not defeated, as the body-guard will dash to the point where he is held, and attempt his rescue; and you know, general, we might almost as well attempt to meet

lightning as that fanatical set of cut-throats. They are, I am told, the choicest men out of a hundred thousand, and fight for the mere love of the fun."

"Where can we remove Hayward, that he will be secure until he entirely recovers?"

"From this point to Springfield, and thence through Arkansas to Memphis."

"But he is a spy, and must hang!" replied Price.

"Such ought to be his fate, I confess. But policy dictates otherwise. He is much beloved by the army, and their revenge would be terrible."

"Do you *fear* their revenge, Captain Branch?"

"Not for myself, general, but for those of our army who might be taken prisoners. The federals would hang a thousand of our friends in retaliation. Besides, he is worth much more as an exchange than as a corpse."

"Your argument is logical, Captain Branch; but Hayward insulted me grossly, at one time, and my heart burns for revenge."

"True, but you can scarcely revenge yourself on such a man. Torture him, and his lip curls as if in very scorn of pain. Threaten him with death, and his proud eye flashes as he replies, 'My country will remember me!' Taunt him—spit upon him—and he does not notice it, except by a haughty air which seems to say, 'I despise you, and take nothing as an insult from those I loathe!'"

"Is there no way to humble him?" asked Price.

"No way! His proud spirit cannot be broken!"

"I will see! I shall visit him in a few moments, and if he accedes to my wishes, very well; if not, he shall be thrown into the dungeon, and there left to rot and die. As you say, sudden death would have no terrors to such a soul, but the damp and darkness of a prison cell will curb that proud spirit. Let me finish this dispatch, and then we will visit him."

Captain Hayward was sitting in his tent, his head bowed upon his hands, apparently buried in deep thought.

"Alibamo," said Hayward, raising his head, "what think you will be my fate?"

"I hope for a rescue!" replied the maiden.

"You are of a hopeful nature, my sweet girl, and I thank you for your words of encouragement. Thank! That is a poor word, Alibamo, for kindness such as yours. You have watched with me constantly, and, like a bright angel, have ministered to my wants. Your presence has cheered me in my sad hours, when pain and suffering had unmanned me. And I love you, Alibamo, almost as much as I love my own darling sister."

"Your sister!" repeated Alibamo, with evident pain. "Yes—I know you love her, for you have often spoken of her in your delirium."

"Have you received any word from our friends?"

"Not one word since that mysterious hand extended to me those words of hope the first night after your capture."

"Nettleton," said Hayward, addressing his attendant, "have you heard me spoken of among the soldiers?"

"Yes, captain, the darn skunks talk about you considerable."

"What do they say?"

"Why, I heerd some on em say it was a darn shame that a bold feller like you should be——"

"Hung up like a dog! Why don't you finish the sentence?"

"Well, that's just what they did say. But I heerd one what ain't very far from you now, say, he'd be d——d if Captain Hayward should die any such way, and when he had waited till the last minute, if no help came, he would put a bullet right through your heart, and save you from the darn rope, anyway!"

"Brave boy! You have a noble heart," said Hayward, grasping his hand.

"No I hain't. Don't say so, captain, cos when you do, I can't keep these dam water-drops out of my eyes, cos I'm a darn skunk anyway, and ain't worth any such words from you."

"Nettleton, how have you managed to remain with me so long without being suspected?"

"O Lord! I'm such a darn skunk nobody would ever think of suspecting me! They think I don't know any more than a half-grown calf. And I spose I don't!"

"How did you get with me at all?"

"Why, after the fight was over I stood right still, and nobody noticed me, except one feller who said, 'Git out of my way, greeney.' And so I followed on after the rest of 'em, and managed to keep with you ever since. And if I can only do you some good, I shall think I ain't quite such a darn skunk after all."

"Nettleton, I wish you would not use that expression quite so often."

"What expression, captain?"

"Why, darn skunk!"

"Well I won't, captain, only I know that I am a darn skunk, any way."

"Captain," said Alibamo, "you spoke of your sister. Is she far from here?"

"Not far—merely in Ohio."

"If by chance you are rescued and removed to the Union camp, do you not wish her sent for?"

"No—not for the world!"

"She *would* come if sent for, would she not?"

"Yes, if she *lived* to get here. But, do not think of such a thing. I shall never see her. But when I am dead, let her know it, but not *how* I died. To know that I *am* dead will break her heart."

Alibamo sobbed audibly.

"Why are you weeping, Alibamo."

"I was thinking of your sister?"

"I wish I could cease thinking of her, now that death is staring me in the face. I do not fear to die, but I do fear to let her know that she no longer has a brother. O Alibamo! if you could see her once, you would not wonder that I love her! Why, she would hang upon my neck, and listen to each word, as if her life depended on her hearing every sound. And when I parted with her for the wars, it seemed as if her soul left with me. She did not weep, but clung to me, while her little form trembled like the lily torn by the tempest's blast. And her last words were, 'Heaven *must* return to me my brother!'"

"And if earth should not, heaven *will*!" sobbed Alibamo.

"Well, I will talk no more of death. The grave looks cold and cheerless, and I shudder as I approach it in this manner. Nettleton, I shall give you some instructions which I know you will see faithfully carried out!"

"You may depend upon it, captain. But you ain't dead yet, and—"

"Major-General Sterling Price," was announced by an orderly.

Price entered the tent.

"Good evening, Captain Hayward. I am glad to see you so far recovered. I trust you will soon be able to receive and wear your sword again!" These words were spoken by Price in a tone of extreme kindness. Hayward looked up surprised, and replied:

"I do not comprehend you, general!"

"That is because you deem me your enemy!"

"And are you not so? If I remember rightly, when we met at your camp on the Osage, you expressed a desire to get Captain Hayward in your power. You have him, now."

"I did not know the man then. He was my enemy, but I can scarcely be an enemy to so brave a man. It is true I have much cause. You came to my camp in disguise, you deceived my orderly and obtained possession of important papers, you placed my scouts in the guard-house for your own safety; you visited and conversed with my officers, gaining all the intelligence you desired; you assisted a prisoner to escape, and meeting a party of my scouts you killed six with your own hand before you were shot

down yourself. The papers which were on your person could not be found, and therefore they must have been sent by you to your general. All this was done with a boldness that wins my admiration, but still its punishment is death."

"Which I expect to receive at your hands," replied Hayward, coldly.

"Your life *may* be spared!" said Price.

"Not a great boon," replied Hayward.

"Do you not wish to live for your sister's sake?" asked Branch.

Hayward started, and a tremor ran through his frame. But in an instant he recovered his self-possession, and said:

"I was conversing with General Price—not you, sir."

Branch bit his lips, but did not speak.

"Well, Captain Hayward, I must speak plainly, and I know you prefer I should do so. It is a pity such a man as you should die, and by the rope. I would much prefer to have met you on the battle-field, but it is too late now. The sentence of your crime is death, and but one thing can save you."

"You need not trouble yourself to name that one thing," said Hayward.

"I see, you understand me. But, the proposition I was about to make was not intended to insult you. *I* honestly believe that I am right, while *you* believe that *you* are. Both of us have sense and judgment. One of us *must* be *wrong*. I believe I have thoroughly examined this matter, and I can but feel that if you would do the same, impartially and without prejudice, you would feel as I do. Understand, our interests at the South are different from yours at the North. We do *not* wish to interfere with *your* government or your interests. We only ask a government of our own, and that you should not interfere with *our* interests. We do not march our armies into *your* territories, and we feel that you have no right to march into *ours*. It will not damage the great North to permit the Southern States to form a government of their own, one that will correspond with their interests; and, so long as we could derive great benefit from it, why should you object? The North is prosperous, because its government is in accordance with its interests and institutions.

The South is *not* prosperous, because the North, governing the whole, has forced upon us a government antagonistic to our interests and institutions. Why not give us a chance for ourselves? But you will not; and so we are compelled to strike for our rights."

"If you truly feel as you speak, you are an honest enemy, at least. You may tell me what the proposition is which you wish to make."

"You are a brave man, and I would like your services and influence in our army and cause. I do not wish you to act against your feelings or principles; but, I heartily wish you could view our cause as I view it, and come with us. You shall have command of a regiment—perhaps of a brigade!"

"General Price," replied Hayward in a mild tone, "I thank you for the delicate manner in which you have made this proposition. I cannot deem it an insult, as your manner is that of a man who makes an offer, sincerely and in good faith, not as a bribe. But I cannot view this matter as you do, and consequently cannot accept your offer or entertain it for a moment. My country, my whole country, right or wrong, is my motto. There is but one flag, and that is the Stars and Stripes, for me."

"I regret it, as I really *do not* wish to see so brave a man die so young!"

"A truce to compliments, General Price. I have done that which I deemed my duty. If you have a duty to perform, and the performance of it calls for my blood, don't let 'my bravery' influence you!"

"Will you give your parole of honor never to take up arms against us again, if I release you?" asked Price.

"No, sir!" was the firm but mild reply.

"You are proud, Captain Hayward!"

"That is not to the purpose, General Price. I shall do nothing, excepting to escape if I can. I ask but one favor of you."

"What is that favor?"

"That you will tell me what is to be my fate!"

"I will do so. To-morrow you start for Springfield under a strong guard. The next day you will be sent forward on your way to Memphis, through Arkansas. At Memphis you will be imprisoned, and detained for the present. There will be little hope of exchange, however, as you are a spy, and must eventually suffer death."

"Why am I not at once executed?"

"Because the federal forces hold some of our prisoners, on whom they would retaliate."

"Will I be permitted to communicate with my friends or send them word where I have been taken?"

"That cannot be permitted," answered Price.

"Under whose charge am I to be sent?" asked Hayward.

"Under that of Captain Branch as far as Springfield. From there it is left to the captain to make further arrangements."

Hayward had started to his feet, and his eyes met those of Branch. There was lightning in that gaze, but it was met with equal sternness.

"Do you object to Captain Branch?" asked Price.

"Yes. I object to anyone who is so great a coward as to strike a wounded, senseless man, merely to revenge himself upon a woman!"

"What do you mean?" asked Price.

"I will tell you. This woman prisoner hates Branch, and I do not wonder. She taunts him, and what woman of spirit would not? He would strike her, if he dare, and because he dare not, he took the noble method of revenge, by striking me in the face with his sword-scabbard, when I was senseless and tied on my horse. He thought *she* would suffer, because I did—the base, cowardly cur."

"Of this I knew nothing. Is it true, Captain Branch?" asked Price.

"It is *not* true, but false as hell, and Hayward knows it is false?" replied Branch, in a rage.

"Well, with this I have nothing to do. Good night, Captain Hayward. If you should make up your mind to accept my terms, let me hear from you."

Price left the tent with Branch.

"Let us sleep, friends, and prepare for to-morrow. God knows what it will bring for us. But still, let us hope. I am glad we go to Springfield."

CHAPTER X.

The Departure—The Meeting—The Sister—The Breaking Hearts.

This is the heaviest blow of all.—*Bulwer.*

The morning dawned, and still Captain Hayward slept. Alibamo was seated by his side, gazing intently upon him. Nettleton was standing in the entrance of the tent. The reveille was beating, and all without gave evidence of preparation to continue the march. As the maiden gazed upon Hayward, she said in saddened tones:

"Would to God I knew the fate hanging over this poor man, or that, whatever it is, I might be permitted to share it with him. But, I fear we shall be separated to-day. That villain Branch will show no mercy when he is under no restraint. Nettleton!"

"Here, Miss Alibamo."

"Have you discovered nothing—no signs of friends?"

"Nothing, but I will not give up yet. We may expect aid at Springfield."

"I fear all is lost. Branch will not permit the captain to remain long in Springfield, as I am told the Union army is advancing. He will be hurried off South, and I suppose we shall be separated to-day. Very likely neither of us will be permitted to go with him."

"You will, miss."

"How do you know this?"

"I'll tell you. Last night I crept close to the tent of Branch and listened. I heard him giving directions to some one he was about to send forward. I heard him say you were to go with him, and that your room would be in the hotel at Springfield which is now used as the rebel hospital. And the captain is to be imprisoned in the cellar of the same building."

"Are you to go with us?"

"I shall go, but as soon as I find out what is to be done, I shall go somewhere else."

"You don't intend to leave the captain?"

"Yes, I do!"

"What! Forsake him now!"

"Who the devil said anything about forsaking him? There's a good deal of difference between leaving and forsaking, I take it."

"I know you will act for the best, my good fellow!"

"Strike tents!" echoed through the camp from without.

"Had we not better wake the captain, Miss Alibamo? It may be the only chance he will get to say anything."

"He is moving—he wakes!"

Captain Hayward opened his eyes, and gazed around. His face while sleeping had worn a smile, but it had faded.

"Good morning, dear friends," said Hayward. "You have been watching with me all night, I fear."

"We have slept, however—that is, I have slept," answered Alibamo.

"I fear but little. You must not do this, Alibamo; you will sink under the fatigues you impose upon yourself. You will require all your strength. And have you slept, Nettleton?"

"Do you think I'd be such a darn skunk as to sleep when I might be doing something? No, I ain't quite so mean as that."

"What have you been doing?"

"Making up my mind—that's all."

"And I have been dreaming, Alibamo. Oh! It was a heavenly vision!"

"What were you dreaming, captain?"

"I was standing upon the margin of the lake near my own dear home. Far out on the waters I heard a sound, low and musical as angels' whisperings. I could not catch the words; still its melody enchanted me, and filled my soul with rapture. Nearer and nearer it approached, and louder and louder became those strains, until the mingling of ten thousand angel voices seemed to make the very waters dance with rapturous delight. My brain grew dizzy, and I sank upon the ground. I raised my eyes, and gazing through the mist, tinted with rainbow hues reflected from the rays of the golden sunset, I saw a thousand fairy forms gliding from point to point, and trilling forth their lays. And on the brow of each I saw emblazoned forth the magic word of *Liberty*! The sight revived me, and springing up, I cried: 'Who are those lovely beings who come forth with my country's jewel glittering on their brow?' A voice replied: 'They are Columbia's daughters—their fetters have been broken—they are free again!' 'Let me embrace them—they are my sisters!' I cried, but at that moment I was seized by an iron hand, and borne from the spot. So rapidly was I whirled along that my senses fled. When I returned to consciousness, I found myself enveloped in a dismal cloud, while at my feet a thousand hissing serpents, which resembled lightning, coiled around, but could not harm me. I heard the dreadful thunders, as they burst over me, but still I feared not. I raised my eyes, and as a cloud rolled by it revealed to my astonished gaze the form of a man standing upon the very edge of a dark cloud, while below him was a precipice, millions of feet. My blood was chilled within me lest he should fall. I heard his cursings, and I saw him reaching forward. I looked farther, and upon another cloud I saw *my* sister standing. She was clothed in white, and on her brow a golden wreath was shining. The clouds were rolling fast together, and he, that fiend-like form upon the other side, was reaching forward, and exulting in the thought how soon he would have her in his grasp, and hurl her down that awful chasm. My brain was reeling, and my heart bursting within me as I gazed upon this scene. I tried to speak, but terror held me dumb. She was almost in his grasp, when my sister raised a dagger, I heard a voice exclaim, 'Hold fast that steel!' I looked, and emblazoned on its polished blade, read the word *virtue*! The villain saw it, and sprang back with a cry of terror. I saw the cloud on which he stood turning to blood, while that upon the other side was tinged with glorious

beauty. The thunder rent the dismal pall, and breaking it in pieces, I saw the villain hurled into the depths below, while hideous fiends held their orgies around him. And then commenced the strains I heard upon the lake. My sister joined the chorus, and gazing on me, smiled. Columbia's daughters came and bore that loved one to my heart, and as I clasped her close, I woke, suffocating with excessive joy!"

"O captain! *that* dream should make you happy—very happy. It fills *my* heart with joy!"

"Why so, Alibamo?"

"Because your troubles will end in the same manner. I feel sure they will."

"It cannot be!"

"And why not?"

"Because my sister was prominent in my vision, she can be in no manner connected with me here!"

"She may hear of your misfortune and visit you here."

"God forbid. No! she has no means of hearing from me. And, if she had, I would rather die a thousand deaths than have that angel sister gaze upon my sufferings. It would add to them a thousand fold, and that would drive me mad."

"Are you ready to depart?" asked Branch, who entered the tent at that moment.

"Quite ready. Am I to walk?" asked Hayward.

"No, you are to ride. Do you prefer a horse or a carriage?"

"It matters very little, as the distance is not far," answered Hayward.

"Then I will send a horse around to your tent. I intend also to grant you a great favor!"

"I shall decline any favors at your hands!" replied Hayward.

"You did not hear what that favor is to be!"

"Well, sir!"

"I intend to permit Alibamo to accompany you as far as Springfield. But tomorrow you are to take your last farewell of her. I have my plans for both you and her arranged."

Branch left the tent. In a few moments horses were brought, and Hayward, with some difficulty gained the saddle. Nettleton helped Alibamo into her seat. By this time Branch came up in company with some twenty horsemen, who were to act as the guard, and the party prepared to depart.

"Is not this young man to accompany us? He has attended to the captain's wounds, and appears familiar with the business. He is a poor, foolish fellow, and will be of little service as a soldier!" said Alibamo, pointing to Nettleton.

"Yes, he can go, if he will walk!" replied Branch.

"Will you go?" asked Alibamo.

"Well, I don't care much about it one way or t'other. But if *you* want me to go with *you* very much, I will, Miss Alibamo," replied Nettleton.

The party set off, and Nettleton trudged along after them, with his usual rickety and unsteady motion, whistling as he proceeded.

They had proceeded about two miles from camp upon the Springfield road, when Branch ordered a halt.

"Where are those hand-cuffs?" he asked.

"Here, sir!" replied one of the soldiers.

"Place them on his hands. No! not that way. Chain his hands behind him! But wait. I will reserve them for future use. Leave his hands free."

Hayward spoke not. In the course of three or four hours they reached Springfield, and halted in front of the hotel building which had been used as a rebel hospital since the battle at Wilson's creek.

"Dismount!" said Branch, in a voice of excitement, mingled with hatred.

Hayward obeyed.

"Is Davis here?" asked Branch.

"Here, sir!" replied a soldier, stepping forward.

"Has the person I wrote for arrived?"

"Yes, she is in a room above!" was the reply.

"O my God!" groaned Alibamo.

"Take that woman away," said Branch, pointing toward Alibamo. Then he added, as she was being led away,

"You shall see your captain to-morrow. And I will show you an amusing sight. You know *it is Friday*, hangman's day." Then turning to Hayward, he added:

"Now will I bend your proud heart. I will show you a pretty sight, presently, *and to-morrow, at three o'clock, we will have a grand review in the fair ground!* Come, follow me."

Hayward turned to speak with Nettleton, who had been standing beside him but a moment before, but he had disappeared.

"Why do you delay?" asked Branch.

"Because it pleases me to do so," replied Hayward.

"Bring a set of chains. Put them on his ankles!" The order was obeyed.

"Drag him along!"

"I will follow you, sir," replied Hayward.

He soon reached the main hall of the building, and, as Hayward followed his captor, the chains clanked heavily upon the floor, and echoed dimly throughout the building.

"You shall behold a friend now, and you will think better of my generosity!" said Branch, as he threw open a side-door. Hayward entered.

A wild scream rang through the room, and a lovely female sprang forward, into the arms of Hayward.

"*My brother! O my brother!*" were the only words spoken, and she became unconscious.

"Mamie—Mamie—Great God! why are you here? Mamie—sister, look up—speak to me—speak, or I shall die—Mamie—O God! she is dead—dead!"

And Hayward sank to the floor, still holding his sister to his heart, and burst into tears.

"Ah! ha! ha! ha! Humbled at last!" cried Branch, as he left the room.

CHAPTER XI.

The War Scout—The Discovery.

Softly—softly as the creeping panther.—*De Soto.*

We left Fall-leaf, Margrave, and Johnson, as they were following the party who had recaptured Hayward and Alibamo. As they descended the mountain, the rear of the rebel army were in sight. At night-fall it halted, and upon the broad prairie, near an oak grove, the camp was soon formed.

"Can you distinguish the rebel general's headquarters?" asked Margrave.

"I was trying to do so," replied Johnson, and his eyes wandered from point to point.

"Do you remember the style of his tent?"

"Perfectly. It is of the pattern known as the *wall-tent*, but of large size. And near it should be about a dozen others of the same description. There it is!"

"Those in the centre—near the grove?"

"Yes—don't you see the rebel ensign waving over it?"

"Very distinctly now. But I do not believe Alibamo, or the captain, will be placed near headquarters. They are the prisoners of that fellow, Branch."

"What shall we do, Johnson?" asked Margrave.

"We must enter their lines to-night, and ascertain where our friends are, and listen to the conversation of the officers, and, if possible, learn what is to be their fate," replied Johnson.

"And we must remember that Captain Hayward is not to be forgotten. He is not dead, or he would have been left on the other side of the mountain, and the drops of blood which we frequently saw along the line of march, is evidence that some wounded person or persons are with the rebels. This

brave captain risked his life for my sister, and I shall risk my life a thousand times for him."

"We must first creep near the sentinels, and when the nine o'clock relief is marched out, we can listen, and gain possession of the countersign. This will be of some assistance to us in case of challenge."

"No—no! White brother stay here! Indian go—creep—softly!" said Fall-leaf.

"No, my brother, you are suffering too severely with your wounds. We cannot permit you to do this, while we remain inactive."

"Look out for the pickets. There is one of their fires," said Margrave, as they approached the oak grove. The party verged their course, and, in a few moments, were within a hundred yards of the camp, concealed almost entirely by the thick wood through which they were passing. Here they paused.

"The darkness favors us!" remarked Margrave. "The moon which was shining so brightly last night, is now entirely obscured by thick clouds. We must wait until after tattoo, and then enter the camp in different directions."

"No—me alone!" replied Fall-leaf. "You—you—me, go—*all* get kill—no help Alibamo! Me go now! *I* get kill—*you* go. You get kill, *you* go. I no get kill, come back. I no come back, *you* go!"

"The Indian means to express himself to the effect, that it is more safe for one to go alone, and if he should get killed or taken, another could go the next night, and another the next? or, that, if two of us should be killed, the third could return and procure more assistance for Alibamo, when he had learned their final destination. We will let the Indian go first. I will write a few words upon a bit of paper, and he may get an opportunity to give it to my sister."

The drums had beat the tattoo, and the relief had passed its rounds. The party listened attentively, but failed to get the countersign, which was given in a whisper. The camp became quiet, and the lights were mostly extinguished.

"Me go now! softly—softly," said the Indian.

"Fall-leaf, give this paper to my sister if you can get an opportunity. If you are discovered, and compelled to fly, we will all meet at yonder rock."

The Indian, without replying, took the bit of paper, and started for the camp. Softly as the creeping panther he worked his way along. He passed the outer row of tents unperceived, and was now fairly within the rebel camp. With cat-like stealth he crept along from tent to tent, listening at each, but not a sound was heard save the deep breathing of the sleepers within. At length the Indian reached a wide avenue, which ran along before a better class of tents than those he had previously passed, and from which were streaming lights. He listened, and could plainly distinguish voices within, but there appeared here a difficulty. Directly in front of the one he wished to reach, a sentinel was stationed, and, if he attempted to cross the broad avenue at that point, it could not fail to attract the watchful guardian's attention.

Just at that moment two forms emerged from the tent, and came directly toward him. It was but the work of an instant for the Indian to conceal himself in the long prairie grass, which fortunately had not been entirely trodden down at this point. He was passed unobserved, and he distinctly heard the name of "Hayward" spoken. He watched, and saw them enter a tent, some twenty rods from that from which they had emerged.

The Indian crept cautiously along. About half-way between the two tents to which his attention had been thus especially drawn, he found the lights extinguished, and he succeeded in crossing the avenue unobserved. He was now in the rear of what he supposed to be the general commanding and his staff officers' quarters. He soon came near the tent into which he had seen the two persons enter, and bending his ear to the ground, he distinctly heard the voices of those within, but could not distinguish the words spoken. He drew nearer, but saw that a guard was stationed on every side, and that it would be impossible to approach nearer without being discovered. He could now hear the voices plainly, and was not long in discovering that both Alibamo and the captain were confined there. Some stratagem must be resorted to, in order to attract the attention of the guard in another direction. The Indian had already torn up the long prairie-grass, and wrapped it

around him in such a manner that he would not easily be seen, so nearly did he resemble the earth around him. He remained perfectly quiet for a moment, as if deeply thinking. At length he commenced a search upon the ground around him. He raised a stone about the size of a large apple, and hurled it toward the woods, in the rear of the last row of tents. It struck against the tree-tops and then fell to the ground, making considerable noise. The guard instantly turned his attention in that direction. He listened, but hearing nothing more, he started with cautious steps toward the wood, his gun at a ready. The Indian at once took advantage of his absence from his post, and darted unseen, close behind the tent. He prostrated himself upon the ground, and drawing the grass around him, and the tent-flap partially over his form, he was safe from detection so long as he did not move. The guard discovering nothing, returned to his post, but the Indian remained quiet, listening to all the conversation within. He became convinced that Nettleton was a friend, and finally attracted his attention, he being seated back of the couch upon which Hayward was lying, and very near Fall-leaf. The Indian waved the paper in his hand, and then let it fall upon the ground. In an instant he sprang to his feet, and dashing the guard to the ground, darted for the woods. He leaped the fence just as the sentinel fired upon him, but the ball whistled by without harming Fall-leaf.

He made all haste to join his friends whom he found awaiting him. It was decided to make no further attempts to enter camp, but they determined to follow on, hoping the prisoners might be left at some point under a small guard, which could be attacked and overcome.

On the morning the squad under the command of Branch left the main army, our friends were well satisfied that their destination was Springfield, and Johnson determined to hasten back to the Union army, and try to procure assistance. Margrave and Fall-leaf followed on, and saw his sister Alibamo and Captain Hayward, enter the rebel hospital. As both were well known in Springfield, Margrave having escaped from that place but a short time previous, assisted by the Indian, their situation was by no means an enviable one. But they mingled with the loungers, and soon learned that a *hanging* was to come off the next day at three o'clock. The great event was to take place in the Fair-Ground.

CHAPTER XII.

Hanging Day—The Friends—The Plot—The Attack.

There is no pang in thy sharp wedge of steel,
After that parting.—*Pythias.*

For some hours, Hayward and his sister were permitted to remain alone. Night was fast approaching. Nothing was heard without, but the coarse laugh and jests of the soldiers. As Hayward held his sister in his arms, he murmured:

"Would to God she could ever remain unconscious, or die to-night. I feel that a fate far worse than death awaits her, when I am gone, and to-morrow will surely be the fatal day. Oh, may God in his mercy protect this darling one!"

"Have I been dreaming?" she sobbed, as she returned to consciousness, and opened her eyes. "I saw my brother in chains, and I heard their dreadful clankings upon the floor."

Her eyes met those of her brother, and with a shudder, she buried her face in his breast, as if she would shut out some terrible vision.

"Mamie—darling sister, don't you know me?" asked Hayward.

"Oh! yes," she cried, starting up. "It is my brother. He is with me, and I am safe and happy. O brother, I met such rude men here, I cannot remain. Let us go at once." She started toward the door.

"Come back, sister, I wish to talk with you, and I wish you to listen calmly."

"Calmly! What do you mean by that word? Ah! those chains! I have not been dreaming! It is a terrible reality. What means this, brother?"

"Come here, Mamie, come close to my heart, and let me talk with you."

She obeyed, but as Hayward placed his arms around her, she said:

"Oh! that iron is so cold—it chills my heart. Let me remove those chains, brother."

"No, sister. Let them alone, and listen to me!"

"First answer *me*! Are these men your friends?"

Hayward could not reply. His feelings almost overcame him, and he did not wish his sister to discover any emotion on his part.

"You are silent. These men are *not* your friends, and you are a prisoner! Oh! my heart will break!" and she sobbed convulsively.

"Don't weep so, dear sister. Don't weep."

"I cannot help it. Oh! let me weep—let me rest upon your heart, brother, and weep my life away! It will be sweet to die here!"

"You must *not* die, Mamie, but live for me. I hope to-morrow I shall be free. I have friends who will not forsake me!"

"And you are a prisoner!" she sobbed.

"Yes, but try and compose yourself. I have much to say to you!"

"Yes, I will be calm—I will listen, for I feel that a terrible fate hangs over you, my brother. Oh! I am glad that I am here. I'll weep no more, but I will comfort you. There, do not look so pale, your little sister is with you, and will share your fate, whatever it may be."

Hayward bowed his head, while a convulsive tremor shook his frame.

"Come, I'll weep no more—I'll comfort you. Think, brother, it can only be death, and your spirit will scarcely have taken its flight to that better world, ere mine will meet you there. Oh! we shall not long be separated."

"Mamie, we will talk no more of death. I do not believe such will be my fate. I have already been informed that friends are at work. I shall be rescued from this place, and if I am not, my sentence is not immediate death. So weep no more, but listen. How came you here, Mamie?"

"I received a letter telling me that my brother had been wounded in battle, and that you wished me to come direct to Springfield. I saw by the papers that the Union army were marching for this place, and I supposed you were with them, and that I should arrive here about the same time you did. I did not hesitate a moment, but came forward according to my directions to Rolla. I was there met by two men who brought me to this place."

"Ah! I see it all now. That villain Branch must have taken your letter from my pocket while I was insensible, and thus learning your address, sent for you!"

"But to what end, brother? He is not your friend or you would not call him villain!"

"I cannot tell, dear sister. But let me enjoin on you to be firm whatever may occur. Even though you see me march upon the scaffold, be firm, and hope. Remember what you said; it will *only* be death! If my enemies wish to torture me, the more keenly feel, the more they will exult. Hark! Some one approaches. We shall not long remain in ignorance. Remember, darling, let not a word or even a tear betray more than ordinary emotion."

The door was thrown open, and Branch entered. Hayward seated himself upon a rude box and Mamie knelt by his side.

"How is your wound, captain?" asked Branch.

"It troubles me very little, sir!" was the reply.

"I do not believe you. You say that to spare your sister pain. You are suffering, and you know it!" growled Branch.

Hayward frowned, but did not speak. His sister crept close to his breast.

"Do you know the federal army are within two days march of this place?" continued Branch.

"I did not know it!" answered Hayward.

"Don't you wish they would come upon us to-night? We have only twenty-two hundred men here, and they with forty thousand *might* defeat us, and rescue you and your lovely sister."

Hayward made no reply.

"Oh! I will open your mouth presently. You saw the Fair-Ground as we passed? You won't speak? Well, I will. If you could only look inside the high board enclosure, you might discover a platform, surrounding a large tree. From one of the limbs a rope is hanging. It is for your neck. You are to die to-morrow at three o'clock."

Hayward did not move a muscle, but Mamie, with a groan of agony, half suppressed, threw her arms around her brother's neck, and clung the closer.

"It will be interesting to die thus, noble captain, knowing that your friends are but a few miles distant. And those lovely arms which now encircle you, will not wish to clasp your neck when you are cold in death. They shall be removed to mine!"

Mamie had started to her feet, and staggering forward, she knelt before the wretch, and sobbed:

"Oh! spare my brother!"

"Mamie!" shrieked Hayward. "Up!"

The maiden started, and sprang into her brother's arms again.

"Forgive a moment of weakness, my brother!" she said, as she caressed him.

"Miss Hayward," said Branch, "Your brother's life may be saved. General Price offered him a pardon, if he would accept a commission in our army. Persuade him to accept it."

Miss Hayward glanced at her brother, and then turning to Branch, she replied:

"And become companion with such as you?"

"Is not that preferable to death?"

"I'll answer you no more!" said Mamie, turning to her brother.

"Well, I will leave you to pleasant reflections. To-morrow at one o'clock you will leave this place, and have the pleasure of a cart ride as far as the gallows. Your sister may remain with you to-night, and enjoy the ride with you to-morrow. After that I shall take charge of her."

Branch left the room.

"It is all over now, brother!"

Miss Hayward could no longer restrain her feelings, but sinking down, groaned in agony of soul. The tears burst forth, and long and bitterly she wept. She could not be consoled. Her brother assured her that he felt confident he would be rescued, if his friends were at that time so short a distance from him. And they might be much nearer. But she could not be comforted. At times her sobs became almost shrieks, and then they would cease, as if from very exhaustion. It seemed as if her very heart was made of tears. Nature could bear but little more. At last she sank into a fitful slumber, resting upon her brother's bosom. Ever and anon she would start, a wild cry would break from her lips, and she would cling with all the power of madness about his neck, and beg him not to leave her. Her starts, her sobs, her groans, her screams, were terrible, and thus the night wore slowly on mid dark and gloom. Hayward slept not. Occasionally he pressed his lips to his sister's forehead, which now was icy cold, now burning with a feverish heat. Sometimes her breath would appear entirely to have stopped, and then her brother, in a voice of agony, would call Upon her name; but a sob or groan would tell him she yet lived. Toward morning she grew more quiet, and her repose seemed sweet, and undisturbed by frightful dreams. At length she started up and cried "They are coming! See, brother!"

"Who are coming, dear sister?" asked Hayward.

"Oh! I have been dreaming, but it was sweet. Are you here, brother? It is so dark I cannot see you!"

"Yes, Mamie, I am here. But, what have you been dreaming?"

"Where are we, brother? Oh! I remember that bad man. I saw him in my dream. He was hurled to destruction from a terrible precipice. He was standing upon a cloud, dark and massive, but the thunders broke it, and he fell!"

"Go on!" cried Hayward.

"I saw you, brother. You were standing on a golden cloud, just by his side. The lightnings flashed around your head, but did not harm you. And when I called you, ten thousand fairy forms appeared, and bore you to my arms. And then I saw all your friends advancing, and they smiled upon you."

"And that dream has given you hope, has it not?"

"Yes, it has, dear brother!"

"It is very strange!" said Hayward.

"That I should dream thus, brother?"

"No, but that last night I had the very same dream!"

"O brother, God is good!"

Hayward told her the particulars of his own dream.

"I shall hope to the last!" replied Miss Hayward, evidently cheered by the vision.

The morning dawned. Hayward looked pale and haggard. The chains had galled him, and he was faint and weak. This he endeavored to hide from his sister, but she observed it, and tried to cheer him with consoling words.

At length some coarse food was brought, and placed just within the door. But it remained untouched. As the day advanced, Hayward said:

"Mamie, what will you do in case of the worst?"

"If you die, do you mean, brother?"

"Yes, darling!"

"Don't trouble yourself as to what I will do *after* you are dead, for if this must be so, I shall go with you."

The door was thrown open and Branch entered.

"It is twelve o'clock," he said. "Make ready!"

"We *are* ready, sir!" answered Hayward.

"It is a pity you should die, Hayward. I tell you what I will do. Let me marry that lovely sister of yours, and I will set you free!"

"Dog!" echoed Hayward.

"What do you say, Miss Hayward?"

"I repeat my brother's word most heartily!" replied Mamie.

"Oh! you scornful little devil, you are a copy of your brother. But you will both repent your words. What ho! guards!"

Four of the guard entered the room.

"Take them along," said Branch.

"We will walk," replied Hayward. As he led his sister from the room he said:

"Think of our dreams!"

Hayward walked erect, almost carrying, rather than leading his sister. When he reached the street he said:

"Branch, my sister will not be able to endure this scene. Let her remain here!"

"No, no," begged Mamie, "let me go with you, brother—I will be very calm—see I can walk alone." But that pale face and trembling form seemed little calculated to undergo the terrible scenes which must follow.

Alibamo was already seated in a rough cart which stood before the door. Hayward assisted his sister into it, and then entered himself, but stood erect, while the females were provided with seats. As they were driven onward, Branch rode by their side upon his horse. A crowd were following after them, and taunts and jeers were heard on every side.

"Oh! that I had a sword within my grasp, and was free from these shackles for a moment, I would teach those curs civility," cried Hayward.

"Oh! it won't matter to you long," said Branch.

The procession had proceeded about a mile from Springfield on the road running west. They were ascending the hill, upon the summit of which was a thick wood, when Hayward said:

"Do you see those lines of infantry just within that grove. They are rebel soldiers; it is the guard *necessary* at the execution of *one* man! Branch, don't you fear that these two half-fainting women will rescue me?"

"They might do it—they are the only ones who can!" replied Branch.

The cart had passed the wood through a line of soldiers formed on either side, and reaching the Fair-Ground, it was driven within the enclosure, and halted near the scaffold. Miss Hayward had been hopeful until this moment, but her feelings gave way, and throwing her arms around her brother, she cried:

"Oh! is there no way in which you can escape this terrible fate?"

"Yes," said Branch. "Accept my terms."

"Dog, still!" replied Hayward, his eyes flashing with indignation.

"Hayward, I will save you, if possible," said Alibamo. "Branch, you say you love me. Release Captain Hayward, and I will become your wife."

"Alibamo!" shrieked Hayward, "unsay those words or I will give you my dying curse! Would you kill *your* brother? He loves you as dearly as I love *my* sister. If I thought, Alibamo, that you would marry that vile wretch, with these chains I would dash your brains out!"

"Drag him upon the scaffold!" shouted Branch.

"Farewell, Mamie—farewell!"

Hayward clasped his sister, but was torn from her, and dragged upon the scaffold, where his chains were removed.

"She has fainted—thank God!" said Hayward, as they placed the fatal noose about his neck.

"The Body-guard! The Body-guard!"

"What shouts are those?" yelled Branch.

At that moment a horseman dashed up, and cried:

"The Body-guard are upon us!"

"Quick!" yelled Branch. "String him up!"

"No, I be d——d if you do, you darn skunks!" cried Nettleton, as he sprang from among the thick branches of the tree, after having severed the rope.

"Spring, captain, for your life," cried Nettleton.

Hayward sprang from the scaffolding. At that moment there was an explosion just beneath it, which threw the masses in every direction, and caused such a dense smoke, that the soldiers surrounding the scaffold could not distinguish the rescuer, and consequently could not fire.

"Alibamo's brother and the Indian were under the scaffold and laid that plot, captain," said Nettleton. "But here comes Adjutant Harry Hinton!"

The adjutant dashed forward, and seeing the captain alive, he fairly yelled with delight. He embraced his friend, and then remounting, cried:

"But come, boys, we have work to do," and off he dashed at a rapid rate.

"Come, Nettleton, I must seek my sister," said Hayward, as he started to the point where he had last seen her. He met the brother of Alibamo, and having been informed by Nettleton who he was, Hayward inquired:

"Where are our sisters?"

"I cannot tell, Captain Hayward. The ground became deserted in a moment after it was known the guard were coming. I suppose Fall-leaf, one of our friends, has removed them to a place of safety, away from the fight. They will be found when the fate of the battle is decided."

CHAPTER XIII.

Charge of the Body-guard.

Advance your standards, draw your willing swords.
For me, the ransom of my bold attempt
Shall be this cold corpse on the earth's cold face;
But if I thrive, the gain of my attempt
The least of you shall share his part thereof.
Sound drums and trumpets, boldly and cheerfully;
God and St. George, Richmond and victory.—*Shakespeare.*

The Union army, having completed the bridge at Warsaw, had commenced their march toward Springfield. They had arrived at a point fifty miles from that place, when they were informed that a body of rebels still occupied that town. The Body-guard, under the command of the gallant Major Charles Zagonyi, were at once sent forward to disperse the rebel band. It was reported that their number did not exceed four or five hundred. That of the Body-guard was one hundred and sixty.

On Thursday evening this enthusiastic squadron of Union troops started upon their march of fifty miles. Onward they rode, all the long night. The morning dawned, and they paused a few moments to refresh themselves and their wearied horses, which had nobly borne their riders forward toward that scene of deadly strife. While they were reposing, a horseman rode up and asked for Adjutant Hinton. The adjutant sprang forward at once, as he recognized in Johnson, one of the party who had visited him at Warsaw and then left in search of Alibamo and Captain Hayward.

"Have you any tidings of our friends?" asked Hinton, in an excited manner.

"Yes; they are now at Springfield. Captain Hayward is recovering, and Alibamo is with him. Fall-leaf and the brother of Alibamo are lurking near

them, and will render all the assistance in their power. But I hope you will not delay long, as a moment may make a world of difference."

Hinton spoke a few words in a low tone to the major, who instantly sprang into his saddle, and commanded an advance.

Onward they dashed. They were just turning a sharp bend in the road, when they came suddenly upon a small party of mounted rebels, who were robbing the house of a Unionist. One of their number discovered the approaching guard, and shouted:

"Here come the d——d Dutch!"

The rebels sprang into their saddles, and an exciting chase begun. But the horses of the Body-guard, worn and jaded, could not overtake those of the rebels, which were fresh. The pursuit was kept up, however, for the next ten miles when Springfield was reached. Here Zagonyi commanded a halt. He was informed that the rebels were in line, and that their numbers were *eighteen hundred* infantry, and *four hundred* cavalry. They held their position on the hill, just within the edge of a thick wood, about one mile west of the city, and near the Fair-Ground.

"Is Adjutant Hinton here?" asked this informant.

"Here," replied Hinton.

"I have a word for you, from William Nettleton!" He whispered a few words to the adjutant, who started, looked at his watch, and replied:

"It is half past two. For God's sake, major, let us on."

"Friends, soldiers!" said the major, addressing those around him, "we are here, in front of the enemy. Their numbers are sufficiently great to overwhelm us—almost *fourteen to one*. But we, soldiers, have been taunted with the name of 'gold-laced body-guard,' 'feather-bed soldiers,' 'kid-gloved gentry,' and such like degrading epithets. I will not *command* you to face such terrible odds, but *I* wish to go, and if you will go with me, I will lead you. If any are sick, let them remain behind; if any one fears, let him also remain. Who will go with me?"

"I shall go, if I do so alone!" cried the adjutant.

The words were scarcely uttered, when the shout went up:

"We all will go—none of us are sick or worn out!"

"Then forward!" cried Zagonyi, as he drove his spurs into his horse.

They rode rapidly along to the west of the city, and came dashing down the road which passed the Fair-Ground. It was the party who had been pursued by the guard, who had ridden up and given the alarm just at the fatal moment, and had thus saved the life of Hayward, by striking terror to the hearts of his murderous enemies.

The Body-guard came thundering on. They were compelled to charge through a narrow lane or road, on each side of which there was a dense oak wood. It was an excellent position for the formation of infantry lines, as it would be impossible for cavalry to advance among the trees. And besides this a rail fence flanked this road on either side, just at the edge of the grove. The rebel lines of infantry were formed on each side of this lane, about ten feet back from the fence. The trees afforded them protection, and as the guard charged through, a murderous fire was poured upon them. But, nothing daunted, they dashed onward. Their purpose was to gain the open field, which declined gradually toward the city, and was situated east of the road. In this field their principal lines of infantry and cavalry were formed. They had scarcely passed the wood when another obstacle to their rapid advance presented itself. A large wagon was placed directly across their path. The horses shied suddenly in passing this obstruction, and some of their riders were violently thrown; but with an extraordinary effort, they succeeded in regaining their seats. Finally a halt was made, and several of the daring spirits sprang from their horses, and commenced the work of tearing down the fence in order that the squadron might ride into the open field, and there form for a charge upon the rebel ranks.

During the whole of this time, the rebels were pouring forth a deadly fire upon the little band, and many of our gallant guard had bit the dust, while the wounded were to be seen on every side.

But, riding into the open field, the guard were formed into line at the base of the hill, near the small stream which is the head of Wilson's creek. On the right of the guard, and about one hundred yards distant, just at the edge of a

large corn-field, were stationed four hundred of the rebel cavalry. At the brow of the hill, directly in front, and near the edge of the wood, was the line of rebel infantry, numbering eighteen hundred, all their available force having been brought to that point.

The eyes of Zagonyi glanced rapidly over this scene. Some thirty of his bold guard had already been stricken down, either killed or wounded. It was enough to appal the stoutest heart. But the major did not flinch—his followers were firm and confident.

"We can spare thirty men to charge their cavalry," said Zagonyi; "lieutenant, will you lead them?"

The officer addressed replied.

"Give me the men—*thirty is sufficient!*"

The men were soon detailed, merely changing front by breaking from the right of the line.

"Forward—trot—*gallop!*" The lieutenant had placed himself at the head of his little band, and with drawn sabres, and a wild shout, they rushed upon the foe. The rebel ranks were broken in an instant; the blows from the terrible weapons of the guard fell not in vain.

"No further help will be required in that quarter," shouted Zagonyi. "Now comes *our* work. Draw sabres—forward—gallop—*charge!*"

A shout rang out upon the air: "*For Fremont and the Union!*" And on they went thundering up the hill. As they approached within a few yards of the rebel line, a terrible fire was poured upon them, but they faltered not. Some of the horses leaped wildly into the air, and then fell to earth dead, but their riders pressed forward.

The rebel ranks could not resist the thunder of this charge. In less than five minutes their lines were completely broken, and the terrified rebels were flying in every direction. Some took refuge in the woods, and fired from behind the trees, while now and then a squad would for a moment make a stand, but it would be quickly dispersed. In half an hour, all firing upon the battle-field had ceased. The rebels were entirely scattered, and were flying

for their lives. Some had taken refuge in the city, and concealed themselves in the surrounding buildings.

Now commenced the charge through Springfield. Up and down the streets rode the guard, charging upon all squads of armed rebels, or pursuing them to the threshold of their own doors. Terror seized upon them all, and soon the Body-guard were masters, not only of the field, but of the city itself.

Then commenced the task of gathering together the Union dead and wounded. Seventeen bodies were found lifeless, and removed to the lower room of the new court-house, then used as the Union hospital, while some fifty were found seriously or slightly wounded, or announced as missing. Thus ended one of the most brilliant charges history has ever recorded.

CHAPTER XIV.

The Conclusion

I have no words—my voice is in my sword.
Thou bloodier villain than terms can give thee out.
Shakespeare.

After finding themselves so thoroughly vanquished at every hand, the panic-stricken rebels fled in every direction, with the utmost precipitation. Their infantry fled into the thick adjoining woods, and thus made their way to the wide spreading prairie beyond, while their cavalry, taking advantage of a moment when the Body-guard were most busily engaged with the infantry lines, sped across an adjoining field, and were soon beyond the reach of danger.

It was in consequence of the general confusion which ensued, that many of the most guilty and cowardly were enabled to effect their escape. This was especially the case with Branch.

At the moment of the explosion under the gallows, he determined not to fight, but to effect his escape with his victims. He urged forward the frightened cattle attached to the cart which contained Alibamo and the inanimate form of Miss Hayward. He proceeded to the western side of the enclosure, and tearing away the high board fence, emerged into the street. Here he beheld the battle raging in the distance, but was too far from the scene to anticipate any particular danger. He opened the fence opposite the place from that which he had left the Fair-Ground, and, driving into a thick wood beyond, soon struck a narrow path, just large enough to admit the passage of the cart. Now for the first time he turned to Alibamo, and said:

"What think you now, my fair one? Is Captain Branch foiled so easily?"

Alibamo did not reply. She held the insensible form of Miss Hayward in her arms, and was striving in every possible way to restore her to consciousness. At length she said:

"Branch, will you not pass me some water from that stream?"

"Will you have it in my cap? It is the only thing in which I can convey it to you!" replied Branch.

"No!" answered Alibamo. "Let us pause for a moment, and you can assist me in removing this dying maiden to the side of the stream. Perhaps the water, dripping cool and fresh upon her forehead will bring her back to consciousness."

"I shall not pause," replied Branch, as he reached the maiden his cap, which he had filled with water.

"You are a vile coward!" replied Alibamo. At this moment her eyes caught the glimpse of something moving among the thick brush near her. Alibamo gazed eagerly forward, as if endeavoring to satisfy herself, and then raising her voice so as to be distinctly heard by any person who might happen to be within several rods of her, she said:

"It is true that you are *alone*, Branch. Here are only two women to oppose you, and one of them is entirely helpless! And yet you fear!"

These words were scarcely spoken, when there was a rustling among the brush, and a dark form appeared.

"No, I am *not* alone," replied Branch. "Look!"

At that instant six of the frightened horsemen, who were riding for their lives, came flashing up, and, reaching the cart, they halted. The dark form which had so suddenly appeared, had as suddenly vanished. It had been distinctly seen by Alibamo, although not by Branch.

As the party rode up, one of them said:

"Why, Branch, what are you doing with these beauties? And one of them unconscious, too."

"Taking them to a place of safety," was the crusty reply.

"You had better take them back to Springfield. The federals will not harm females."

"No—no! that is not my purpose. They are relatives of Union officers, and I intend to keep them as hostages for the safety of our friends."

"Where do you purpose taking them!"

"To the dwelling of Captain Rogers, on the edge of the prairie, just west of the Wilson's creek battle-ground."

Another slight noise was heard among the underbrush, and Alibamo made a significant motion to some person, or to some imaginary object, and then all was silent.

Miss Hayward had partially recovered under the cooling effects of the water with which Alibamo had been bathing her brow. She opened her eyes, and then, with a shudder, closed them again. At length she said in a feeble tone:

"O brother! press me closer to your heart; I am cold—very cold!"

"Miss Hayward, your brother yet lives, and will be with you soon!" whispered Alibamo, as she bent over the fast recovering maiden.

"Oh! yes, my brother must live—he does live!" cried Mamie, starting up.

"Who is your brother?" asked one of the party.

Miss Hayward gazed upon the questioner, but turning away, she hid her face in the bosom of Alibamo and wept.

"I will answer for her!" replied Alibamo. "He is an officer in the Union army. He was taken prisoner while endeavoring to rescue me, who also have been kept as a *hostage* by that villain, Branch. It was the intention of Gen. Price to release or exchange this young lady's brother, but, he, to gratify his own fiend-like propensities, was about to disobey the express orders of the general, and hang young Hayward."

A groan broke from Miss Hayward, but Alibamo quickly replied:

"Don't fear, darling, the Body-guard came just in time to rescue him, and he will soon be with us!"

"Are you *sure* of that?" asked one of the party.

"I *know* it will be so. There will be large parties sent in every direction, and you will be surely overtaken!" answered Alibamo.

"Let us forward, then," replied one of the rebels, his cheeks blenching with fear.

"Stay one moment," answered another. "Branch," he continued, "you have the reputation of a bad man. I shall not permit you to keep these ladies, if I can prevent it. Let me accompany them back to Springfield, and restore them to the arms of their friends!"

"Indeed!" replied Branch with bitterness. "You are very kind, and I have no doubt the ladies will thank you. But I do not understand exactly *how* you are going to prevent me from doing as I please. Pray be good enough to explain."

"I will! Men, you are enemies to the federal soldiers only, not innocent women. Seize that cowardly captain, and I will return with the ladies, and restore them to their friends. It will benefit all those of our friends who _____"

A ball, fired from the pistol of Branch, went crashing through the brain of the speaker, and he rolled from his horse a corpse.

"You see how far his interference has benefited him," said Branch, pointing to the dead body. "Are there any more who wish to share his fate?"

The party were silent. They were now ascending the sharp hill, or range of hills, which skirts the creek upon the north. Turning to the right, he proceeded onward, but observing he was not followed, he asked:

"Why do you halt?"

"Because we go in another direction."

"I command you to follow me," yelled Branch.

"We do not recognize your authority."

"You shall see it here," replied the infuriated captain, as he drew forth his revolver.

In an instant the five horsemen had leveled their rifles at his breast, and one of them said:

"Go your way, sir, and we will not molest you. Be careful how you interfere with us."

"Do as you please, cowards," replied Branch. He started on his way, while the horsemen proceeded down the hill at a rapid rate.

Alibamo bent forward, and whispered words to Mamie, which seemed to be those of hope, as the countenance of the latter brightened very much. Then, starting to her feet, while her frame quivered with excitement, she cried:

"I knew it would be so! Look there, Miss Hayward! Look there!"

"What do you mean?" yelled Branch.

"That you are foiled at last, fiend of darkness, that you are."

Let us return to Springfield.

The excitement endured by Hayward, together with the pain he suffered from the constant irritation of his wounds, and his loss of blood, were more than he could bear, and he sank to the earth, although he still retained his consciousness. Nettleton remained by his side, although Hayward urged him to join his brothers in the unequal contest.

"There ain't no occasion to do that!" said the brave fellow. "Them Body-guard will whip them darn skunks in less than three minutes, and besides some on 'em might come around you, and I calculate if they do, to make them smell brimstone."

The fight was over. Nettleton and William Margrave assisted Captain Hayward to the city, and secured a room for him in one of the houses

occupied by a Union family. In a short time both Johnson and Adjutant Hinton joined him. The Indian was absent.

"Have you received any intelligence of my sister?" asked Hayward, in a trembling voice.

"Not yet, but Fall-leaf is absent, and I feel satisfied that he is with or near both your sister and mine," replied Margrave. "He will return with them very soon, I believe."

"Did you see or hear anything of Branch?" asked Hayward.

"After the smoke from the explosion had cleared away, I went in search of the ladies, but they had disappeared. The cart had been removed, and my opinion is that Branch has driven off with our sisters. He cannot advance very rapidly with his ox-team, and, if Fall-leaf is on his track, he will return and inform us as soon as he has ascertained the direction they have taken."

"Have the horses saddled, and at the door. If possible get fresh ones," said Hayward. "I shall follow my sister."

"You cannot do it, captain, you are too ill!"

"Who talks of being ill, at such a time as this? My sister is in the hands of that ruffian Branch, and yours too, Margrave! *I* should go forward if I was dying!"

At this moment Fall-leaf rushed into the room, and cried:

"Follow—come!"

"Come—no questions," cried Hayward.

In an instant Hayward, Hinton, Johnson, Nettleton, Margrave, and the Indian, were in their saddles, and darted off at their utmost speed, on the road toward the famous Wilson's creek battle-ground. The Indian took the lead.

They ascended the sharp hill which borders Wilson's creek, and when on its summit, could plainly see all the surrounding objects in the valley below. After a moment's inspection they turned to the right, and struck off through

a narrow path which ran along the mountain ridge. They had proceeded about two miles, when the Indian paused and said:

"Hark!"

The party listened attentively, and distinctly heard the sound of the rumbling cart.

"Quick! Forward!" cried Hayward, as he dashed onward. In a few moments they came in sight of the cart, and there, sure enough, were seated the sister of Hayward and the maiden, Alibamo.

A cry of joy broke from the lips of Margrave. It was heard by Branch. The villain for a moment was confused, but it was no time for delay. He seized Miss Hayward in his arms, and, springing from the cart, ran along with her as easily as if she had been an infant.

Alibamo sprang into her brother's arms, with a cry of rapture, but he only paused a moment. Branch ran directly toward a narrow pathway, which was the only passage to the valley below, and which wound down the steep by the side of a sharp, rocky ledge. Beneath this ledge was a frightful chasm, at the bottom of which were a hundred sharp rocks, which had been broken off the height, and fallen into the depths below.

"Ah! I will triumph yet!" cried Branch, as he reached the ledge, and was about to spring down the narrow pathway. But, Fall-leaf confronted him, and Branch sprang back.

"Ah! the rock—the precipice!" he cried, and darting for the ledge he stood upon its very verge.

As Hayward and his friends approached, Branch raised the helpless maiden high over his head, and leaning forward he cried:

"If you advance another step, Hayward, or permit any of your party to do so, I will hurl your sister into the depths below, and thus dash her to pieces!"

Hayward was within a few feet of Branch, but he stopped instantly.

"What is to be done?" asked Hinton, as he shuddered at the scene before him.

"I will tell *you* what is to be done, Hayward," cried Branch. "I hold *you* in my power, and I shall dictate my own terms."

"What are they?" asked Hayward.

"Let the entire party, excepting yourself withdraw some distance to the rear, and then swear by your honor that I shall not be molested, and shall be permitted to go as I please, and I will restore your sister. If you do not, she shall perish, even if I go with her!"

The villain, who supposed his proposition would be readily accepted, had been partially thrown off his guard. With a cry of

"Brother!" Mamie sprang suddenly to the ground. In doing so, she had collected all her strength, and, as she sprang, the concussion had thrown Branch backward, and he was falling over the ledge. He caught a small sapling in his fall, and there the villain hung, suspended over this dreadful gulf, only by the frail twig. He turned upward an imploring glance, but did not speak. He gazed below, and a thrill of terror shook his frame.

"Your hour has come!" cried Hayward, as he approached the edge of the cliff.

"No! no! me—me!" cried the Indian, stepping forward.

"Oh! save me!" groaned Branch.

"Pray," said Hayward, as he saw the tomahawk of the Indian raised high in the air.

"Save me—save—" Branch spoke no more.

The tomahawk had descended and severed the frail twig, to which Branch was clinging. A yell of terror rose upon the air, as Branch went whirling down, and then a dull, heavy thump was heard and all was still.

Hayward pressed his lips upon his sister's forehead, and murmured,

"The dream, darling—the dream!"

"O brother," she sobbed, "I cannot speak—I am so happy!"

Margrave had not been idle. He had taken a full share of embraces, and had handed Alibamo over to Adjutant Hinton, who appeared rather to relish that luxury, himself. Johnson was a silent spectator, but Nettleton was dancing with perfect ecstasy, as he exclaimed:

"Well, I'm about the happiest darn skunk that ever did live!"

"Fall-leaf, have you nothing to say?" asked Hayward.

"Me kill—ugh!" he pointed toward the rocks below, and seemed perfectly satisfied.

"Bad man—*much* bad!" and he strode away up the path.

Night was fast approaching, and the happily united friends set out for Springfield, which they reached in safety.

Captain Hayward recovered from his wounds, and is still engaged in fighting his country's battles, while his lovely sister is happy in her home upon the lake.

Adjutant Hinton is in the same regiment with Hayward, while Alibamo—*not* Alibamo Margrave, but Alibamo *Hinton*, is adorning her husband's elegant home in New York, where she is its light and joy. She only awaits the return of Harry to render her perfectly happy.

Nettleton thinks he is becoming less of a "skunk" every day, but still insists on remaining with Haywood, as his "body-guard." Fall-leaf still serves the army.

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